

U.S. DEPARTMENT OF AGRICULTURE
WASHINGTON, D.C. 20250

DEPARTMENTAL MANUAL	NUMBER: DM 4620-002
SUBJECT: Common Identification Standard for U.S. Department of Agriculture (USDA)	DATE: April 20, 2026
OPI: Office of Safety, Security, and Protection (OSSP)	EXPIRATION DATE: April 20, 2031

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1. PURPOSE

- a. This Departmental Manual (DM) provides procedures for United States Department of Agriculture (USDA) staff to meet the requirements of the Departmental Regulation [\(DR\) 4620-002](#), *Common Identification Standard for U.S. Department of Agriculture*.

2. SCOPE

- a. This DM applies to all USDA Mission Areas, agencies, and staff offices including the employees (as defined in [5 U.S.C. § 2105](#), *Employee*) and other categories of persons such as affiliates, contractors, fellows, interns, vendors, and volunteers who have a relationship with USDA under a contract, grant, or other agreement within them. For the remainder of this DM the other categories of persons who have a relationship with USDA under a contract, grant, or other agreement will be referred to collectively as “non-Federal employees”.

3. SPECIAL INSTRUCTIONS/CANCELLATIONS

- a. This manual supersedes DM 4620-002, *Common Identification Standard for U.S. Department of Agriculture*, dated December 09, 2021.
- b. No provision in this DR shall have the effect of nullifying or limiting protections for equal employment opportunity as provided in Title VII of the Civil Rights Act, Equal Employment Opportunities, [42 U.S.C. § 2000e](#), et seq., and [Executive Order \(E.O.\) 11478](#), Equal Employment Opportunity in the Federal Government and [E.O. 13087](#). USDA prohibits discrimination in all its programs and activities on the basis of race, color, sex, national origin, religion, age, disability, genetic information, marital status, parental status, political affiliation, receipt of public assistance, pregnancy, childbirth, or related medical conditions, or any other non-merit based factor. Persons with disabilities who require alternative means for communication of program information (e.g., Braille, large print, audiotope) should contact USDA's TARGET [Technology and

1 Accessible Resources Give Employment Today] Center at (202) 720-2600 (voice and
2 Telecommunications Device for the Deaf (TDD)). To file a complaint of discrimination,
3 write to USDA, Assistant Secretary for Civil Rights, Office of Civil Rights, Center for
4 Civil Rights Enforcement, 1400 Independence Avenue, S.W., Mail Stop 9440,
5 Washington, DC 20250-9410 or call 1-800-795-3272 (voice) or (202) 720-6382 (TDD).
6 USDA is an equal opportunity provider and employer.
7

8 4. BACKGROUND 9

10 Prior to the inception of HSPD-12, federal agencies used a wide range of methods to
11 credential and authenticate federal employees and contractors as a requirement to enter
12 federally controlled facilities and information systems. HSPD-12 required a Governmentwide
13 Standard for secure and reliable forms of identification (ID) issued to Federal employees and
14 contractors.
15

16 This DM provides procedures to keep USDA in compliance with federal policy and
17 standards regarding the credentialing of Federal and non-Federal employees. The primary
18 policies and standards to support the procedures in this DM are:
19

- 20 a. Homeland Security Presidential Directive 12 ([HSPD-12](#), *Policy for a Common*
21 *Identification Standard for Federal Employees and Contractors*, which mandated the
22 development and implementation of a mandatory, Governmentwide Standard for secure
23 and reliable forms of identification (ID) issued to Federal employees and contractors.
24 HSPD-12 compliant identification:
25

- 26 (1) Is issued based on sound criteria for verifying an individual employee's identity;
27
28 (2) Is strongly resistant to identity fraud, tampering, counterfeiting, and exploitation;
29
30 (3) Can be rapidly authenticated electronically; and
31
32 (4) Is issued only by providers whose reliability has been established by an official
33 accreditation process.
34

- 35 b. The National Institute of Standards and Technology (NIST) Federal Information
36 Processing Standards Publication ([FIPS PUB](#) 201-3, *Personal Identity Verification*
37 *(PIV) of Federal Employees and Contractors* which:
38

- 39 (1) Defines a reliable, Governmentwide PIV system for use in applications such as
40 access to federally controlled facilities or information systems;
41
42 (2) Specifies a PIV system within which common identification badges can be created
43 and later used to verify a claimed identity; and
44
45 (3) Requires identity proofing and background investigations (BI) to verify identity.
46

- 1 c. Office of Management and Budget (OMB) implementation Memoranda [M-05-24](#),
2 *Implementation of Homeland Security Presidential Directive (HSPD) 12 – Policy for a*
3 *Common Identification Standard for Federal Employees and Contractors*, and [M-19-17](#),
4 *Enabling Mission Delivery through Improved Identity, Credential, and Access*
5 *Management*, which provide guidance for implementing the requirements in FIPS PUB
6 201-3 and HSPD-12. The guidance clarifies timelines, applicability, and the
7 requirements of PIV.
8
9 d. Office of Personnel Management (OPM) [Credentiaing Standards Procedures for](#)
10 [Issuing Personal Identity Verification Cards under HSPD-12 and New Requirement for](#)
11 [Suspension or Revocation of Eligibility for PIV Credentials](#)
12
13

14 5. PRIVACY POLICY

15
16 HSPD-12 explicitly states that “protect[ing] personal privacy” is a requirement of the PIV
17 system. As a USAccess customer, USDA’s PIV process and system is in accordance with
18 the spirit and letter of all privacy controls specified in FIPS PUB 201-3, as well as those
19 specified in Federal privacy laws and policies including but not limited to the [E-Government](#)
20 [Act of 2002](#), the [Privacy Act of 1974](#), and OMB Memorandum [M-03-22](#), *OMB Guidance for*
21 *Implementing the Privacy Provisions of the E-Government Act of 2002*, as applicable.
22
23

24 6. CREDENTIAL TYPE DETERMINATION

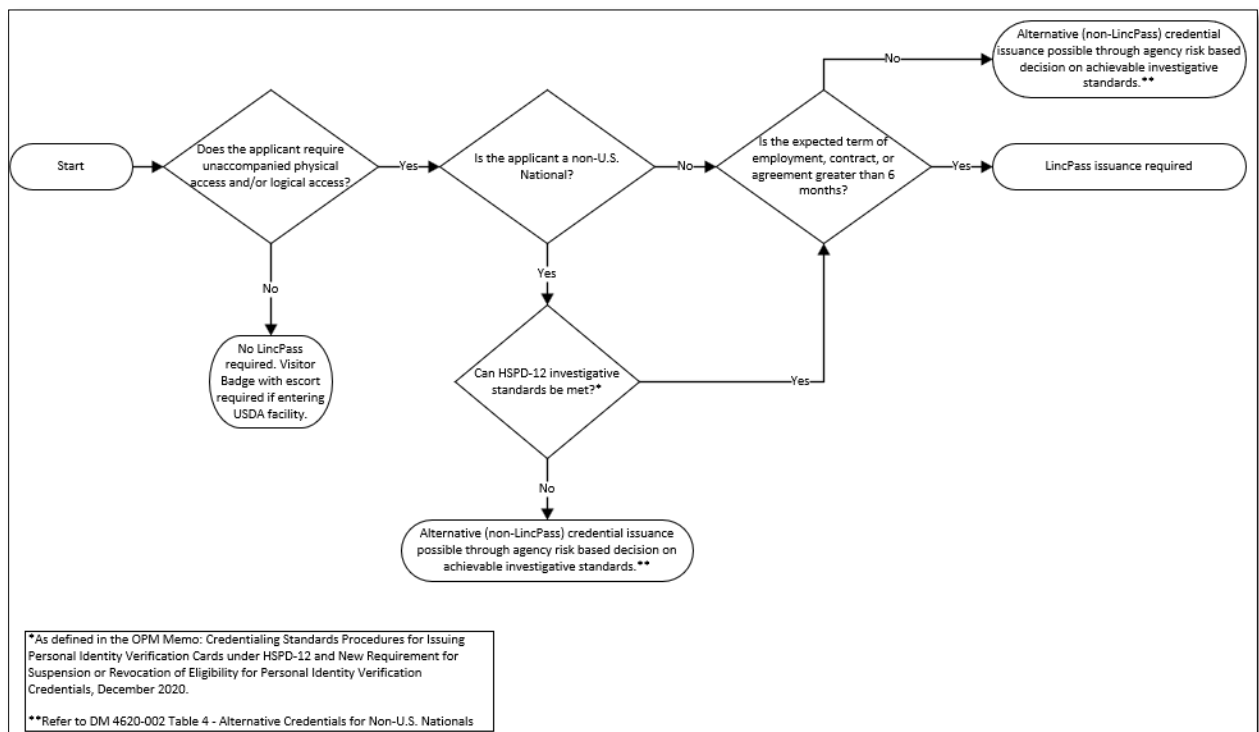
25
26 The credential determination flowchart in Figure 1 can be generally used to determine the
27 appropriate credential type necessary to meet credentialing standards. When following the
28 decision chart in Figure 1 there are three main decision points to consider:
29

- 30 1. Determine the type(s) of access needed by the applicant. Credentialing determinations
31 consider whether the applicant will require unaccompanied physical access to USDA
32 facilities and/or if they will be accessing USDA information systems.
33
34 2. Determine whether the applicant is a non-U.S. National, also commonly referred to as
35 a Foreign National. Non-U.S. Nationals have different investigative standards applied
36 to them and close coordination with Personnel Security is required to determine
37 whether the applicant is eligible to meet those standards prior to sponsorship for a
38 credential.
39
40 a. The following policies must be applied when performing credentialing and
41 adjudicative determinations for non-U.S. Nationals:
42 i. [OHRM/OCP/OHS Memo - Hiring Non-United States \(U.S.\) Citizens](#)
43 [as Federal Employees or Federal Contractors – November 15, 2023](#)
44 ii. [OHS Memo - Investigation Requirements for Foreign Nationals Not](#)
45 [Meeting U.S. Residency Requirements for a Tier 1 – January 24, 2023](#)

- iii. [OPM Memo – Credentialing Standards Procedures for Issuing Personal Identity Verification Cards under HSPD-12 and New Requirement for Suspension or Revocation of Eligibility for Personal Identity Verification Credentials – December 15, 2020](#)
- iv. [Secretary Memo 1078-014 – America First Memorandum for USDA Arrangements and Research Security – July 8, 2025](#)

3. Determine the applicant’s expected term of employment/contract/relationship with USDA. This will determine if the applicant is considered short-term. This will depend on whether the duration of the relationship is greater than or less than 6 months.

Figure 1 - Credential Type Decision



Any logical access granted in association with the credentials listed in this section must meet the requirements of DR 3505-003.

The only HSPD-12 compliant credential at USDA is the PIV, commonly referred to as the LincPass as described in Table 1.

Table 1 – LincPass Matrix for U.S. Nationals

USDA Credential Name	Credential Type	Standard Usage	BI Level Required	Issuer
LincPass	HSPD-12 Compliant Personal Identity Verification (PIV)	Long term (6 months or greater) employees and non-Federal employees requiring routine access to federal facilities or information systems.	Interim Determination: FBI Fingerprint Check & Scheduled Tier 1 (minimum) Final Determination: Tier 1 (minimum)	USAccess

Table 2 - LincPass Matrix for Non-U.S. Nationals

USDA Credential Name	Credential Type	Standard Usage	BI Level Required	Issuer
LincPass	HSPD-12 Compliant Personal Identity Verification (PIV)	Long term (6 months or greater) employees and non-Federal employees requiring routine access to federal facilities or information systems.	Fully adjudicated Tier 1 (minimum) or equivalent Background Investigation and Employment Authorization Verification based on the investigative standards identified in DM 4620-002 Section 6(2)a NOTE: Issuance under Interim Determination is generally not permitted for non-U.S. Nationals except for exempted categories of FNs considered US Persons in US locations that meet the residency standards for a BI.	USAccess

Alternative credentials listed in Table 2 may be issued in accordance with DR 4620-002 for circumstances where the requirements of HSPD-12 cannot be met.

Table 3 - Alternative Credential Matrix for U.S. Nationals

USDA Credential Name	Credential Type	Standard Usage	BI Level Required	Issuer
AltLinc	PIV Interoperable (PIV-I)	Short-term (less than 6 months) employees and non-Federal employees requiring routine access to federal facilities or information systems.	FBI Fingerprint Check (minimum)	USAccess
Site Badge	Proximity/CIV Card	1. New employees/contractors awaiting the issuance of a PIV requiring unescorted physical access. 2. Unescorted physical access for short-term intermittent access.	FBI Fingerprint Check (minimum)	Mission Area, agency, staff office
Visitor Badge	PVC/Proximity/CIV Card/Sticker	Escorted access for visitors to a facility. Not intended for regular/routine access for federal and non-federal employees.	None	Local Site
ID Badge	Non-PIV Agency Managed Credentials	As defined in DR 4620-002 – Section 3C - Law Enforcement, Food Inspection, Animal Care, Protective Detail, etc... Not applicable for physical or logical access.	Agency Specified	Mission Area, agency, staff office
MobileLinc	PIV Derived (PIV-D)	Logical access only. Requires PIV for issuance. A digital credential stored electronically on mobile device.	Interim: FBI Fingerprint Check & Scheduled Tier 1 (minimum) Final: Minimum Tier 1	OCIO
Alt MFA	Alternate Multi-Factor Authentication Credentials (Yubikey/Windows Hello for Business)	Logical access only. Usage for alternate authentication when PIV is unavailable.	Refer to BI requirements for Active Directory accounts in DR 3505-003	OCIO

Table 3 - Alternative Credential Matrix for Non-U.S. Nationals

USDA Credential Name	Credential Type	Standard Usage	BI Level Required	Issuer
AltLinc	PIV Interoperable (PIV-I)	1. Facility access card for Non-U.S. Nationals unable to meet investigative standards for PIV Tier 1 BI residing in U.S. based locations or U.S. Territories until the 3-year time in U.S. or U.S. Territory can be met and a BI can be completed. 2. Facility access card for non-U.S. Nationals in foreign locations unable to meet investigative standards for Tier 1 BI	1. Investigative standards identified in DM 4620-002 Section 6(2)a 2. Investigative standards identified in DM 4620-002 Section 6(2)a and approval by the Director of the USDA Office of Homeland Security and Under Secretary or responsible Mission Area, Agency, or Staff Office head.	USAccess
Site Badge	Proximity/CIV Card	Fully vetted new employees/contractors awaiting the issuance of a PIV requiring unescorted physical access.	Fully adjudicated Tier 1 (minimum) or equivalent Background Investigation and Employment Authorization Verification based on the investigative standards identified in DM 4620-002 Section 6(2)a	Mission Area, agency, staff office
Visitor Badge	PVC/Proximity/CIV Card/Sticker	Escorted access for visitors to a facility. Not intended for regular/routine access for federal and non-federal employees.	Coordination through the OHS Foreign National Visitor program	Local Site

7. ROLES AND RESPONSIBILITIES

- a. The role holder actions defined in this section are to be completed in the following authoritative systems for USDA.

(1) **Authoritative HR System – EmpowHR.** Employment status changes made in the authoritative HR System are automatically fed into the Authoritative PIV Issuance System, Enterprise Physical Access Control System, and other IT systems for the automatic disabling of credentials, physical and logical access during suspension and termination actions. Processing for Federal and non-Federal employees must be completed in the following modules:

(a) **PAR Processing** – for Federal employee personnel

(b) **Non-Employee Processing (commonly referred to as Person Model)** – for non-Federal employee personnel and pre-hire selectees for federal employment

1 (2) **Authoritative PIV Issuance System – USAccess.** GSA’s shared service system for
2 the issuance of the PIV and PIV-I card utilized by USDA.

3
4 b. Mission Areas, Agencies, and Staff Offices

5
6 The HSPD-12 program is governed by the USDA HSPD-12 Program Management
7 Office (PMO). The PMO partners with Mission Area, agency, and staff offices in
8 implementing HSPD-12 throughout USDA. HSPD-12 implementation is coordinated
9 through a partnership between the PMO and the designated Mission Area, agency, or
10 staff office Lead and Alternate.

11
12 The PIV process contains critical roles associated with the identity proofing,
13 registration, and issuance process. These roles may be collateral duties assigned to
14 personnel who have other primary duties. The PIV identity proofing, registration and
15 issuance process must adhere to the principle of separation of duties to ensure that no
16 single individual has the capability to issue a PIV credential without the cooperation of
17 another authorized person.

18
19 The following roles must be employed for identity proofing, registration, and issuance.

20
21 c. Applicant

22
23 The Applicant is an individual who requires a credential as a condition of employment
24 with a Mission Area, agency, or staff office that will be entered into the authoritative
25 PIV issuance system. Applicants will:

- 26
27 (1) Provide HR User and Sponsor with any necessary information;
28
29 (2) Provide Personnel Security with necessary information required to initiate or
30 validate investigative checks;
31
32 (3) Submit fingerprints for a background check;
33
34 (4) Schedule an enrollment appointment at a USAccess credentialing station;
35
36 (5) Appear for the enrollment appointment at the time and place scheduled;
37
38 (6) Provide the Registrar with two U.S. Citizenship and Immigration Services (USCIS)
39 [Form I-9](#) listed identity documents;
40
41 (7) Submit to a digital photo taken by the Registrar;
42
43 (8) Submit ten digital fingerprints (rolls and slaps). If the capture of 10 fingerprints is
44 not feasible due to missing or damaged fingers, this will be annotated in the system;
45
46 (9) Digitally sign the enrollment package;

- (10) Activate the credential via biometric verification and Personal Identification Number (PIN) creation;
- (11) Ensure the credential is registered for logical and physical access;
- (12) Ensure that the Sponsor or Agency Security Officer is notified if the card is lost or stolen immediately;
- (13) Store credentials in a badge holder and fastened to either an item of clothing or lanyard;
- (14) Wear credentials above the waist in such a manner that the ID photograph is clearly visible from the front at all times;
- (15) Wear an armband holder or place the credential in a pocket, if it is permissible, if the applicant works in a hazardous environment where it would be unsafe to wear the credential in the manner outlined; and
- (16) Properly wear and display the credential once the person leaves the hazardous work area (e.g., if the credential had been placed in the pocket, it must be properly worn and displayed again). Mission Area, agency, or staff offices must define the work areas in which it would be unsafe to wear the credential as outlined in this section.
- (17) Return expired or terminated credentials to the Security Officer, local badging office, or mail to the address printed on the back of the PIV card.
- (18) Never share their credential with another person
- (19) Never use their credential to provide physical or logical access to someone other than themselves
- (20) Never leave credential unattended in a workstation or in an unsecured location not on the person when not in use

d. HR User

The HR User is responsible for creating and modifying an Applicant's information in the authoritative HR system(s). Often the HR User and the Sponsor roles are held by the same person, but it is not required.

e. Sponsor

The Sponsor is the Mission Area, agency, or staff office official who has undergone Sponsor training and is designated to perform Sponsor functions. The Sponsor is responsible for authorizing an individual to apply for a credential. In the case of non-Federal employees, the Sponsor should be the Contracting Officer's Representative

(COR) or other designated program official as specified in the [USDA Contracting Desk Book](#). To leverage existing roles in the LincPass process, MobileLinc responsibilities have been added to the Sponsor role.

Sponsors will:

- (1) Validate that the Applicant's information has been entered into the authoritative HR system;
- (2) Ensure that applicant records for non-federal employees are linked to a specific contract number or unique agreement ID in the authoritative HR system. Creating a singular record as a catch all for multiple contracts/grants/agreements is prohibited.
- (3) Ensure that the contracts, grants and agreements in the authoritative HR system are created with valid Period of Performance dates specified in the linked document;
- (4) Ensure that contracts entered in the authoritative HR system are linked to a specific company/organization or sufficient detail is provided in the contract description or notes field;
- (5) Determine the appropriate credential type by utilizing the information in Section 6 – Credential Type Determination;
 - (a) Coordinate with agency Personnel Security to determine highest achievable investigative standards, investigation completion status, and other required compliance steps as required in DM 4620-002 Section 6(2)a prior to entering Sponsorship for non-U.S. nationals;
- (6) Modify the Applicant's identity record in the authoritative database based on updates to user status and relevant information;
- (7) Update and maintain the Applicant's Sponsorship in the authoritative HR system;
- (8) Maintain current employment status:
 - (a) Termination: As needed, set employment status to Terminated in the Human Resources (HR) record in the authoritative HR system; and
 - (b) Suspended: As needed, set the employment status to Suspended in the HR record in the authoritative HR system.

To ensure timely provisioning and de-provisioning of accounts (e.g., desktops, eAuthentication, building access, National Finance Center (NFC) applications, MobileLinc credential management accounts), Mission Area, agency, or staff offices must record hiring and termination events in the authoritative HR database as soon as possible.

1
2 Federal employee employment status changes and account de-provisioning not
3 related to an imminent risk shall follow normal OHRM processes and timeframes
4 for HR system update.
5

6 Non-Federal employee employment status changes and the de-provisioning of
7 accounts not related to an imminent risk must be completed within 24 hours of
8 separation. The Sponsor must notify personnel security of non-Federal employee
9 termination so the date of separation can be recorded in webSETS.
10

- 11 (9) Trigger the following card actions as needed in the authoritative HR and PIV
12 issuance systems:
13
- 14 (a) Suspense: Monitor card status and change to “Suspend”. If suspense is based
15 on employment status, ensure the card status change is reflected in both the
16 authoritative HR and PIV issuance systems. If suspense is a result of
17 disciplinary action, manually update the card status to “Suspend” in the
18 authoritative PIV issuance system first and notify the Agency Security Officer,
19 subsequently making the update in the authoritative HR system. If possible,
20 recover the suspended credentials and send to the Security Officer for secure
21 storage pending resolution of issue(s).
22
 - 23 (b) Termination: Monitor card status change to “Terminated”. If termination is
24 based on employment status, ensure the card status change is reflected in the
25 authoritative HR and PIV issuance systems after 30 days. All employment
26 terminations in the authoritative HR system will begin as a temporary Suspend
27 status to the USDA credential and PIV issuance employment status for 30 days
28 prior to final terminated status taking affect from the employment Termination
29 in the authoritative HR system. At the end of the 30-day suspension period, the
30 card will automatically switch from suspended to terminated unless a system or
31 manual action is taken to change the status to Active.
32
 - 33 (c) If card Suspense/Termination is due to notification of imminent risk,
34 immediately make the change directly in the authoritative PIV issuance system
35 and notify the Agency Security Officer and HSPD-12 Adjudicator,
36 subsequently making the change in the authoritative HR system.
37
 - 38 (d) Re-enrollment: Initiate re-enrollments for current or previous cardholders in
39 the event of a change in the Applicant’s identity information or an expired
40 enrollment.
41
 - 42 (e) Certificate Rekey: Ensure the HR record is accurate and trigger a card update
43 or certificate rekey as appropriate due to data update. Note that normal 3-year
44 certificate expirations will automatically be triggered by the USAccess system.
45

- (f) Renewal: Ensure cards are renewed every 5 years per FIPS PUB 201-3 by initiating a renewal or reprint.
- (g) Reissue: Enrollments expire after 12 years, and a re-enrollment is required prior to the issuance of a new PIV card. Initiate a Reissue request to start the re-enrollment and card issuance process.
- (h) Reprint: Ensure cards are reprinted as needed due to damage or loss.

f. PIV Registrar

The Registrar is an individual responsible for identity proofing the Applicant, as well as capturing biographic information, digital photo, and biometrics. Registrars will:

- (1) Manage the schedule for enrollment workstations through the utilization of the online scheduling tool or by providing a direct phone number or email for applicants to make appointments; this includes cancelling appointments in a timely manner and providing direct reach out to applicants if same day cancellation is required.
- (2) Answer any privacy or system related questions that an Applicant may have or refer them to the USDA [HSPD-12 Helpdesk](#);
- (3) Locate and open the Applicant's information and verify the information with the Applicant;
- (4) Refer the applicant to their Sponsor if applicant's record cannot be found in the system to investigate and resolve the problem;
- (5) Verify and scan the Applicant's two identity source (I-9) documents;
- (6) Verify and enter biometric information;
- (7) Capture the Applicant's facial image in the system via a digital photograph;
- (8) Capture 10 digital fingerprints (rolls and slaps) into the system. If capture of 10 fingerprints is not feasible due to missing or damaged fingers, annotate the record in the system;
- (9) Verify the fingerprints images for quality issues and re-scan if needed in order to achieve the highest possible quality fingerprint capture.
- (10) Flag any documentation issues for Agency Security Officer review during enrollment; and
- (11) Digitally sign and save the enrollment package.

(12) Respond to USDA HSPD-12 PMO and USAccess inquiries in a timely manner.

(13) Perform credential reroutes to other credentialing stations upon request of the USDA HSPD-12 PMO and USAccess.

g. HSPD-12 Adjudicator

The HSPD-12 Adjudicator is a Federal employee of the sponsoring Mission Area, agency, and staff office who records the results of the Federal Bureau of Investigation (FBI) National Criminal History Check (FBI fingerprint check) and/or the requisite BI (T1 or higher) into the authoritative HR system. The HSPD-12 Adjudicator role referenced here is not to be confused with the suitability/fitness Adjudicator role as defined by OHS-PDSD. While both roles can be held by the same person, it is not required.

Final PIV adjudication is aligned with the OHS-PDSD personnel vetting (suitability/fitness) processes. Results of personnel vetting (suitability/fitness) process as determined by OHS-PDSD will be utilized as the final determination for PIV adjudication results. These results will be recorded in the web-based Security Entry Tracking System (webSETS), the system of record for background investigation determinations at USDA, or its successor.

HSPD-12 Adjudicators will:

- (1) Enter fingerprint check results in the authoritative HR system. Entry of fingerprint check results separately from BI results will expedite printing of the LincPass and is highly recommended for U.S. Nationals. This will result in an interim PIV issuance, pending completion of the BI. If the results are favorable, and all other issuance rules are met this will allow the LincPass to print prior to the completion of the BI. If the results are unfavorable, this will terminate the card issuance process.

The interim determination process is generally not permitted for non-U.S. Nationals except for exempted categories of FNs considered US Persons in US locations that meet the residency standards for a BI.

To issue an interim PIV issuance the following steps must be complete:

- (a) Presentation by the appointee or employee of two identity source documents, at least one of which is a Federal or State government-issued picture identification.
- (b) Favorable review of the intended PIV recipient's completed investigative questionnaire;

- 1 (c) Initiation of the intended PIV recipient's required BI (T1 or higher) request,
2 meaning the request has been submitted to the Federal background
3 investigation service provider (ISP), and the ISP has scheduled the
4 investigation; and
5
6 (d) Favorable review of the results of the intended PIV recipient's Federal Bureau
7 of Investigation (FBI) National Criminal History Check (FBI fingerprint
8 check) portion of the required BI.
9
- 10 (2) Confirm and enter the BI results in the authoritative HR system: entry of BI results
11 will finalize the eligibility process for the Applicant. If the results are favorable,
12 this will allow the Applicant to maintain their LincPass. If the results are
13 unfavorable, this will terminate the card.
14
- 15 (3) Respond to inquiries on adjudication status from Applicants; and
16
- 17 (4) Report any changes in PIV eligibility to the applicant Sponsor and Agency Security
18 Officer and update authoritative systems as necessary.
19
- 20 h. Print Operator
21
- 22 The Print Operator is the individual responsible for processing credential production at a
23 designated USDA Local Printing station. The Print operator verifies that the Applicant is
24 the person to whom the credentials are to be printed. Print Operators will:
25
- 26 (1) Receive blank cardstock credentials from the HSPD-12 PMO and sign for packages
27 (dependent on shipping model).
28
- 29 (2) Secure blank cardstock in a locked safe or lockable filing cabinet and monitor all
30 credentials that are deposited or removed from the safe.
31
- 32 (3) Verify that the Card Serial Number and other Applicant information entered in the
33 system and the information on the printed credential agrees.
34
- 35 (4) Hand the newly printed credential to the Activator for activation.
36
- 37 (5) If print errors occur, flag the credential in the system and note problems with card
38 printing.
39
- 40 (6) Collect the misprinted credentials and keep a log.
41
- 42 (7) If applicable, destroy misprinted credentials or ship them to the Agency Security
43 Officer as appropriate; and
44
- 45 (8) When requested, securely send credentials to another Activation Station.
46

1 i. Activator

2
3 The Activator is the individual responsible for processing credential activations. The
4 Activator verifies that the Applicant is the person to whom the credentials are to be
5 issued and guides the Applicant through the activation process.

6
7 Some activation stations use an unattended mode for activation, meaning that Applicants
8 will use the system without assistance to activate their credentials. If there is an issue
9 causing the unattended activation to fail, the Activator will assist the Applicant in
10 completing the activation, or collect the credential, note the issue in the system, and flag
11 the record for issue resolution.

12
13 The Activator can also assist in card maintenance activities such as certificate updates
14 and PIN resets.

15
16 Activators will:

- 17
18 (1) Receive credentials from the authoritative PIV issuance systems centralized printing
19 facility or another station and sign for packages (dependent on shipping model).
20
21 (2) Check credentials in using the Credential Inventory Tool (CIT) and send out
22 electronic notifications to the Applicants either directly or through the CIT.
23
24 (3) Secure credentials in a locked safe or lockable filing cabinet and monitor all
25 credentials that are deposited or removed from the safe.
26
27 (4) Hand the credential to the individual after document and visual verification.
28
29 (5) Verify that the Applicant information entered in the system and information
30 displayed on the credential agrees.
31
32 (6) Flag the credential in the system and note problems with activation.
33
34 (7) Collect the credential if activation fails. In the event a card becomes damaged or
35 defective, the Activator will utilize the CIT to queue the card for systematic
36 destruction. The Activator will then physically destroy the card per guidance from
37 the LincPass/AltLinc card destruction guide.
38
39 (8) In the event a card becomes damaged or defective, and the activator does not have
40 the means to destroy the card, it can be returned via shipment through a shipping
41 company (such as UPS/FedEx) or USPS with tracking and signature confirmation
42 in a sealed non-transparent packaging to the USDA South Building – OSSP Facility
43 Protection Division (FPD), 1400 Independence Ave SW, Rm 1408, Washington,
44 DC 20250.
45

(9) When requested, send credentials via shipment through a shipping company (such as UPS/FedEx) or USPS with tracking and signature confirmation in a sealed non-transparent packaging to another Activation Station.

j. Agency Requestor

The Agency Requestor role is reserved for the HSPD-12 PMO and is responsible for the submission of change requests to the GSA USAccess Assured Identity Request Manager (ARM) tool.

k. Agency Request Viewer

The Agency Request Viewer is reserved for the HSPD-12 PMO and has view only rights into the ARM tool.

l. Credential Inventory Tool (CIT) Operator

The CIT Operator is responsible for the inventory and management of the physical credentials onsite at a credentialing station. The CIT operator will:

- (1) Check in credentials within 1 business day of receipt.
- (2) Send credential check-in emails to the applicant notifying them that the card is ready for activation.
- (3) Ensure that site-specific instructions are accurate in the automated email template
- (4) Mark credentials as terminated when processing for destruction

m. Finance POC

Role reserved for the HSPD-12 PMO with access to GSA USAccess invoice files. The Finance PO will review and reconcile the invoices and provide to the USDA OCFO for action.

n. Report Viewer

The report viewer role can access the GSA USAccess reports portal. This role is read/view only and does not have the ability to make changes to USAccess data. The

The Report Viewer will:

- (1) Follow proper handling procedures for reports that include Personal Identifying Information (PII).

(2) Acknowledge that the reports are For Official Use Only (FOUO) and shall not be disclosed outside any agency who is affiliated with the GSA Managed Service without written assurance from the agency Privacy Officer or responsible office that the provisions of FOIA under Exemptions 2 of the Act 5 U.S.C. para 552(b)(2) (2000) have been observed.

o. Agency Role Administrator

The Role Administrator is the individual responsible for managing the Mission Area, agency, and staff office Sponsors, HSPD-12 Adjudicators, Registrars, Security Officers and Activators. USDA has one Role Administrator who oversees all individual Mission Area, agency, and staff office Role Administrators. The Role Administrator will verify that the appropriate separation of duty policy is followed and will verify that all the training certification requirements have been met. Role Administrators will:

- (1) Ensure separation of HSPD-12 duties.
- (2) Ensure that role holders are adequately trained for their assigned role.
- (3) Submit access requests to authoritative HR system for appropriate roles.
- (4) Approve role holder portal privileges in the authoritative PIV issuance system for new role holders.
- (5) Revoke role privileges and portal access for users in cases where the role will no longer be performed by the user or upon employment termination.
- (6) Unlock accounts as needed if locked due to inactivity.

p. Local Role Administrator

The Local Role Administrator has the same responsibilities as the Role Administrator but with a limited scope of roles available to assign. The Local Role Administrator is a secondary agency role to the Role Administrator and will be able to assign and manage (including unlocking accounts) the following scoped roles:

- (1) Activator
- (2) Adjudicator
- (3) Credential Inventory Tool Operator
- (4) Local Site Manager
- (5) PIV Registrar

1 (6) Print Operator

2
3 (7) Report Viewer

4
5 (8) Sponsor

6
7 q. Agency Security Officer

8
9 The HSPD-12 Security Officer is the individual responsible for maintaining credential
10 security and integrity of Applicant identity information. To leverage existing roles in the
11 LincPass process, PIV-D credential responsibilities have been added to the Security
12 Officer role. Security Officers will:

13
14 (1) When required, immediately change the status of a credential between active,
15 suspended, or terminated due to security-related situations such as notification of
16 imminent risk.

17
18 (a) If suspense or termination is a result of disciplinary action, or imminent
19 danger, immediately manually update the card status in USAccess if the
20 Sponsor has not done so.

21
22 (b) If possible, recover the credential immediately and store securely until
23 destruction can occur.

24
25 (c) Notify the following groups of the imminent risk:

26
27 1 HSPD-12 Sponsor and Adjudicator, if these POCs are not known please
28 contact the HSPD-12 Help Desk at USDAhspd12help@usda.gov;

29
30 2 Security services at the impacted federal facility – in the case of the
31 National Capitol Region (NCR), contact OSSP at
32 securityservicehelp@usda.gov;

33
34 3 Local law enforcement - 911 for emergency.

35
36 4 Federal law enforcement through the fusion center ([fusion center contact](#)
37 [information](#));

38
39 5 OHS Insider Threat (insider@usda.gov), Counterintelligence
40 (CI@usda.gov), and Personnel Document Security Division
41 (CNSIS@usda.gov); and

42
43 6 OHRM (humanresources@usda.gov) or applicable Mission Area, agency
44 and staff office Personnel Security staff if records are not held by OHRM;

45
46 7 Workplace Violence Prevention Program Hotline (202-603-5366).

- (2) Report any potential security anomalies, suspicious behavior, concerns, or incidents regarding USDA employees or contractors to OHS PDSD at CNSIS@usda.gov and OHS Insider Threat Program at insider@usda.gov;
- (3) Report any potential security anomalies, suspicious behavior, concerns, or incidents regarding foreign nationals to the OHS Counterintelligence Program at CI@usda.gov;
- (4) Collect and destroy credentials. In the event a card becomes damaged or defective, destroy the card following the steps dictated in the [USDA HSPD-12 LincPass Destruction Guide](#) or return the card to USDA South Building – OSSP FPD, 1400 Independence Ave SW, Rm 1408, Washington, DC 20250;
- (5) In the event of duplicate records in the authoritative PIV issuance system, verify the Applicants' identity information and purge erroneous records;
- (6) When required, request that the Mission Area, agency, or staff office information technology (IT) support help desk personnel revoke the PIV-D credentials in the event of a lost or stolen device or a security incident; and
- (7) Review and make determinations on any records flagged during the enrollment process for Security Officer review.

r. Agency Site Manager

The Site Manager is responsible for managing credentialing center information and the schedule for USDA Credentialing stations. Site managers will:

- (1) Manage site information, weekly site schedules, and site points of contact (POC) for all types of credentialing stations in the authoritative PIV issuance system's site inventory tool;
- (2) Validate the concurrence of ship-to location information between the authoritative HR system and the authoritative PIV issuance system, and correct conflicts as needed;
- (3) Validate the concurrence of all types of credentialing stations between the authoritative PIV issuance system's site inventory tool and the USDA Master Deployment Inventory; and
- (4) Validate the concurrence of all types of credentialing stations between the authoritative PIV issuance system's site inventory tool and center locator tool.

s. Local Site Manager

1 The Local Site Manager is similar to the Agency Site Manager role but has a limited
2 scope of access to sites. The Local Site Manager is responsible for managing
3 credentialing center information and the schedule for a specific subset of USDA
4 Credentialing stations. Local Site managers will:

- 5
6 (1) Manage site information, weekly site schedules, and site points of contact (POC)
7 for all types of credentialing stations in the authoritative PIV issuance system's site
8 inventory tool.
9

10
11 8. CREDENTIALING SITE HOSTING RESPONSIBILITIES
12

- 13 a. Unless the site has received a waiver from the HSPD-12 PMO, USDA credentialing
14 sites must:
15

- 16 (1) Meet the USAccess site requirements as defined in the USAccess Program Ready
17 Guide – available on request from the [HSPD-12 Help Desk](#)
18
19 (2) Register credentialing stations with an Agency or Local Site Manager
20
21 (3) Be listed in the GSA hosted Find A USAccess Center online tool
22
23 (4) Utilize the AI Scheduler online tool or post POC information on the fedidcard.gov
24 Find A USAccess Center tool for appointment scheduling purposes
25
26 (5) Be listed as a Ship To location to receive direct shipments of PIV cards from
27 USAccess central printing
28
29 (6) If designated as Shared Status, service all USAccess customer agency employees
30 and contractors as schedule availability can accommodate.
31
32 (7) If designated as Dedicated Status, service all USDA employees and contractors,
33 regardless of Mission Area, Agency, or Staff Office as schedule availability can
34 accommodate.
35
36 (8) Respond to HSPD-12 PMO, USDA Helpdesk, and USAccess Helpdesk inquiries in
37 a timely manner. Note that decisions to fulfill accommodation requests for non-
38 USDA applicants at Dedicated sites, or for any applicant type outside of regularly
39 scheduled site operations is at the site POC and registrar/activator's discretion.
40
41 (9) Perform card reroutes as needed. Note that the site is not expected to pay shipping
42 costs for card reroute requests. Requesting agency must provide a shipping label
43 with request.
44
45 (10) Maintain the latest version of the USAccess software on the credentialing units
46

- (11) Maintain USAccess accounts to avoid lockout actions by logging into a USAccess portal at a minimum every 90 days
- (12) Report all changes in operational status and site points of contact to the USDA [HSPD-12 Helpdesk](#)
- (13) Utilize the Credential Inventory Tool to check-in PIV cards delivered to the site in a timely manner (within 2 business days)
- (14) Maintain an accurate appointment schedule and perform direct reach out to applicants and cardholders in the event of a cancellation
- (15) Regularly check [TRACKS](#) to stay informed on system issues and outages as well as to access GSA produced job aids
- (16) Maintain membership to the USDA [HSPD-12 Teams Site](#) to receive newsflash communications and resource guides
- (17) Abide by GSA USAccess system and program policy and guidelines
- (18) Abide by all Federal, Departmental, and Agency privacy policies and guidelines while dealing with Personally Identifiable Information (PII)

9. ROLE HOLDER REQUIREMENTS

- a. All USAccess role holders shall meet the following minimum requirements:
 - (1) Have a legitimate need for the role
 - (2) Be designated by the Agency or Local Role Administrator
 - (3) Be a U.S. Citizen
 - (4) Have an active LincPass
 - (5) Complete any required role-based training
 - (6) Have a completed or scheduled Tier 2 Background Investigation for all roles except the Adjudicator, Activator, and Credential Inventory Tool Operator
 - (a) The Activator and Credential Inventory Tool Operator only require a Tier 1 Background Investigation.
 - (b) Per Part 1400 of Title 5 in the Code of Federal Regulations (CFR), Designation of National Security Positions, “*Exercising investigative or adjudicative duties*

1 *related to national security, suitability, fitness or identity credentialing*” the
2 HSPD-12 Adjudicator is designated as a national security position and should
3 receive a Background Investigation commensurate with the level required by
4 the Position Designation Tool but as a minimum require:
5

6 1 Personnel adjudicating Tier 1 and Tier 2 cases, a minimum Tier 3
7 investigation is required.
8

9 2 Personnel adjudicating Tier 3, Tier 4, or Tier 5 cases, a Tier 5
10 investigation is required.
11

12 b. The HSPD-12 Sponsor and HSPD-12 Adjudicator roles require corresponding roles in
13 the authoritative HR system. The provisioning and management of roles in the
14 authoritative HR system is the responsibility of the role holder’s Mission Area, agency,
15 or staff office.
16

17 c. Some HSPD-12 issuance roles are inherently governmental functions and require the
18 role holder to be a federal employee. Other HSPD-12 roles allow a contractor to perform
19 the function. Please see Table 3 below for employment requirements by role. Waivers
20 or exemption from this policy are only approved for:
21

22 (1) Members of the HSPD-12 PMO contract support staff and helpdesk where role
23 access is required for troubleshooting or view only support purposes.
24

25 (2) Role holders on a case-by-case basis as formally approved by the Chief Security
26 Director of the Office of Safety, Security, and Protection.
27

1

Table 4 – Role Holder Employment Type Matrix

Role	Can the role be held by a non-federal employee?
Activator	Yes
Agency Requestor	No
Agency Request Viewer	Yes
Agency Role Administrator	No
Agency Site Manager	Yes
Adjudicator	No
Agency Security Officer	No
Credential Inventory Tool Operator	Yes
Finance POC	Yes
Local Role Administrator	No
Local Site Manager	Yes
PIV Registrar	Yes
Print Operator	Yes
Report Viewer	Yes
Sponsor	No

2

3

4

10. ROLE HOLDER TRAINING

5

6

Training for certain HSPD-12 roles held in the USAccess system is required. Training is provided through the following methods:

7

8

9

(1) [GSA USA Learning Web Based Training](#)

10

11

(2) [USDA AgLearn Web Based Training](#)

12

13

(3) Guides and Job Aids available through the [USDA HSPD-12 Teams Site](#)

14

15

(4) Instructor-led training (virtual or in person)

16

17

The type of training and means of completion will depend on the role type requested and is defined in Table 4.

18

19

20

Table 5 – Training Requirements

Role	Title of Training Required	Training Location
Activator	1. Activator	GSA PIV Training (usalearning.gov)
Adjudicator	1. HSPD-12 Adjudication Training	USDA AgLearn
Agency Security Officer	1. Security Officer	GSA PIV Training (usalearning.gov)
Credential Inventory Tool Operator	1. Credential Inventory Tool Job Aid	USDA HSPD-12 Teams Site
PIV Registrar	1. 2-day Registrar training (virtual or in person) provided by GSA Or , if #1 is not available and the registrar need is urgent it is acceptable to accept the GoLearn training (option #2) as sufficient training to assign the role. 2. Registrar Training Note: GSA also hosts a monthly online refresher training. For more information visit the HSPD-12 Teams Site .	1. Contact HSPD-12 Helpdesk to register 2. GSA PIV Training (usalearning.gov)
Print Operator	1. Local Print Operator Guide 2. Local Print Troubleshooting Guide	USDA HSPD-12 Teams Site
Report Viewer	1. USAccess Reports Guide 2. Applicant Status Report Guide	USDA HSPD-12 Teams Site
Sponsor – Servicing Federal Personnel	1. HSPD-12 Sponsorship of Federal Personnel Training 2. HSPD-12 Post Sponsorship Training	USDA AgLearn
Sponsor – Servicing Non-Federal Personnel	1. Sponsorship of Non-Federal Personnel 2. HSPD-12 Post Sponsorship Training	USDA AgLearn
Role Administrator	3. HSPD-12 Role Administrator Guide Training	USDA AgLearn
Local Role Administrator	4. HSPD-12 Role Administrator Guide Training	USDA AgLearn

11. PROCEDURES

a. Reciprocity of Credentialing Determinations

Per the [OPM Credentialing Standards](#), USDA must not re-investigate or re-adjudicate individuals visiting or temporarily or permanently transferring from another Department

1 or Agency provided a final favorable PIV eligibility determination exists based on an
2 investigation that is at an appropriate tier for the new position.

3
4 b. PIV Issuance Guidelines

5
6 (1) PIV Applicability

- 7
8 (a) PIV requires the implementation of registration, identity proofing, and issuance
9 procedures in line with the requirements of FIPS PUB 201-3.

10
11 All individuals must follow the procedures outlined to apply for and receive
12 their credentials. USDA uses the USAccess program, a certified NIST Special
13 Publication [\(SP\) 800-79-2](#), *Guidelines for the Authorization of Personal*
14 *Identity Verification Card Issuers (PCI) and Derived PIV Credential Issuers*
15 *(DPCI)*, PIV Card Issuing Organization, for PIV issuance.

- 16
17 (b) A Social Security Number (SSN) is required for entry of applicant records into
18 the authoritative HR systems. SSNs for non-citizens can be obtained through
19 the Social Security Administration process outlined in Publication No. 05-
20 10096. In the event the applicant is a foreign national locally employed by
21 USDA and cannot obtain a SSN a Foreign ID must be obtained through the
22 Department of State.

23
24 (2) Credentialing Standards

25
26 In accordance with OPM guidelines, a PIV credential will not be issued to an
27 individual if any of the following applies:

- 28
29 (a) The individual is known to be or reasonably suspected of being a terrorist;
30
31 (b) The employer is unable to verify the individual's claimed identity;
32
33 (c) The employer has a reasonable basis to believe the individual has submitted
34 fraudulent information concerning his or her identity;
35
36 (d) The employer has a reasonable basis to believe the individual will attempt to
37 gain unauthorized access to classified documents, information protected by the
38 *Privacy Act*, information that is proprietary in nature, or other sensitive or
39 protected information;
40
41 (e) The employer has a reasonable basis to believe the individual will use an
42 identity credential outside the workplace or inappropriately; or
43
44 (f) The employer has a reasonable basis to believe the individual will use federally
45 controlled information systems unlawfully, make unauthorized modifications

1 to such systems, corrupt or destroy such systems, or engage in inappropriate
2 uses of such systems.

3
4 (3) Revocation and Suspense of PIV Eligibility
5

- 6 (a) Mission Area, agency, and staff offices must develop procedures which adhere
7 to standards defined by OHS-PDSD to notify the cardholder's HSPD-12 role
8 holders (Sponsor, HSPD-12 Adjudicator, and Agency Security Officer) in the
9 event of any incident or adverse credible information that would impact PIV
10 eligibility.
11
12 (b) HSPD-12 role holders must follow the steps defined in the role holder's
13 responsibilities section of this document to ensure timely
14 suspension/revocation of the PIV card due to the result of a change in
15 eligibility.
16
17 (c) Making the required status and eligibility changes in the authoritative USDA
18 systems, will automatically remove logical access to IT systems as well as
19 physical access to Enterprise Physical Access Control Systems.
20
21 (d) USDA Mission Area, agency or staff offices may perform Barring Actions at
22 their respective locations outside the National Capitol Region. These actions
23 will be done in accordance with USDA Mission Area, agency or staff office
24 policies and will be reported to OSSP.
25

26 (4) Background Investigation Requirements
27

28 BI standards and requirements are developed by OPM Suitability Executive Agent
29 (SuitEA) with compliance oversight performed by OHS.
30

31 (5) Expiration Date Requirements
32

33 (a) LincPass Expiration Date
34

35 All PIV credentials issued to the USDA must have a printed expiration date.
36 The printed expiration date on the LincPass is by default set for 5 years from
37 the date the card was issued unless the appointment or hiring term is for a
38 period less than 5 years. In this case the expiration date can be set for the end
39 of the identified term. Certificates embedded on the card enabling digital
40 signatures are only valid for 3 years. PIV credentials for non-Federal
41 employees must be terminated at the end of the contract, grant, or agreement
42 period of performance.
43

44 (b) AltLinc Expiration Date
45

1 The AltLinc is a short-term credential and has a maximum expiration date of 6
2 months from the credential issuance.

3
4 (6) Contracting Impacts

5
6 All non-Federal employees must abide by the identity proofing and registration
7 requirements outlined in this DM. USDA contract statements of work must
8 indicate that all contractors requiring routine access to federally controlled
9 facilities or information systems go through the identity proofing and
10 registration process and have a successfully adjudicated background
11 investigation commensurate with the duties of the position and requirements of
12 the contract to serve on the contract.

- 13
14 (a) While there is no official USDA procurement policy requiring PIV language to
15 be included in grants or agreements, in keeping with the policies and
16 procedures for contracting, the process outlined in this manual must be
17 followed for other non-contractor, non-Federal employees (e.g., affiliates,
18 fellows, interns, or volunteers).
19
- 20 (b) Contractor LincPasses for U.S. nationals can be issued under an interim
21 determination after a favorably adjudicated fingerprint check has been received
22 by Mission Area, agency, and staff office Personnel Security Officer, and upon
23 a scheduled background investigation commensurate with the duties of the
24 position and requirements of the contract. The interim determination process is
25 generally not permitted for non-U.S. Nationals except for exempted categories
26 of FNs considered US Persons in US locations that meet the residency
27 standards for a BI.
28
- 29 (c) Certain PIV language must be implemented in all contracts. This language is
30 found in *Federal Acquisition Regulation (FAR)* [48 CFR Subpart 4.13](#),
31 *Personal Identity Verification of Contractor Personnel*. HSPD-12 clauses
32 include FAR [48 CFR Clause 52.204-9](#), *Personal Identity Verification of*
33 *Contractor Personnel*. Agriculture Acquisition Regulation (AGAR) 404.13,
34 *Personal Identity Verification*, AGAR clause 452.204-70, *Personal Identity*
35 *Verification of Contractor Employees*, and the USDA Contracting Desk Book
36 404.13, *Personal Identity Verification*, contain additional procurement
37 guidance.
38
- 39 (d) The language provided in FAR Subpart 4.13, AGAR 404.13, and the USDA
40 Contracting Desk Book 404.13 may be modified for use in any non-contract
41 grants or agreements.
42

43 (7) Audit and Records Management
44

- 1 (a) The Office of the Inspector General (OIG) has responsibility for auditing
2 identity proofing and registration records. As such, all Mission Area, agency,
3 or staff offices should be prepared for such reviews.
4
5 (b) Mission Area, agency, or staff offices must comply with [DR 3080-001](#),
6 *Records Management*, for the creation, maintenance, use, and disposition of all
7 records associated with the PIV process.
8

9 (8) Timely Issuance and Continuity of Credentials
10

11 To ensure timely issuance of credentials for newly onboarded employees, the
12 Mission Areas, agency, and staff office personnel should:
13

- 14 (a) Enter the Personnel Action Request (PAR) for new hires (Nature of Actions
15 100s) or non-federal employee identity (for Contractors), in EmpowHR, at
16 least one full pay period prior to Entrance on Duty (EOD) date.
17
18 (b) Complete sponsorship for a specific credential type and set a valid ship to
19 location a minimum of 1 business day prior to EOD.
20
21 (c) Request logical access account creation and complete provisioning prior to
22 EOD.
23
24 (d) Routinely review USAccess issuance statuses of pre-hire selectees and clear all
25 failed issuance rules that will prevent credential issuance on EOD.
26

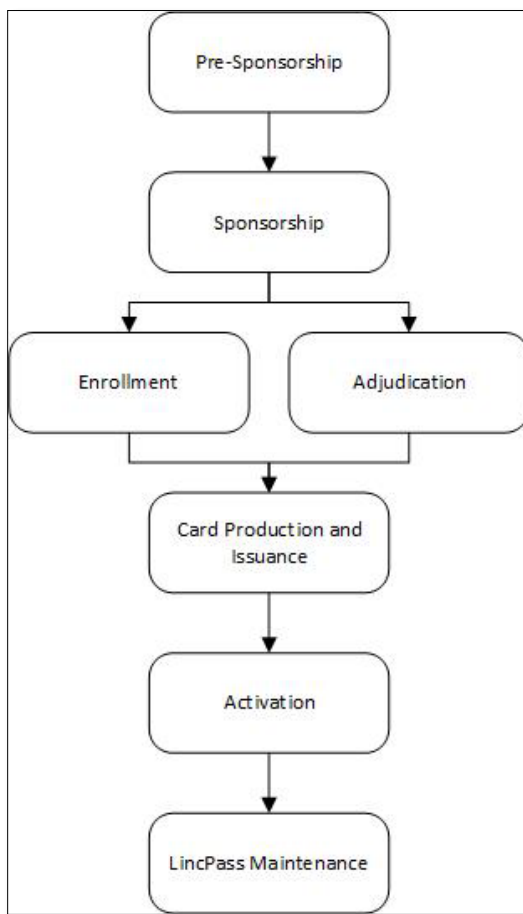
27 To ensure continuity of credentials for employees transferring within the USDA,
28 the Mission Areas, agencies, and staff offices should not terminate and collect
29 credentials if there will not be a break in service. Nothing printed physically on the
30 credential or contained in the digital certificates needs to be updated for an
31 intradepartmental transfer and the credential can continue to be utilized. A new
32 credential must be issued if the cardholder is changing employment types, such as
33 contractor to employee, as employment type is distinguished visually on the
34 credential.
35

36 c. PIV Issuance Process
37

38 (1) LincPass Issuance Steps
39

40 Figure 2 provides an overview of the LincPass credentialing steps and associated
41 processes for onboarding and card usage.
42

Figure 2 – PIV and PIV-I Issuance Process



(a) Pre-Sponsorship

- 1 The HR User creates or validates the required Applicant information in the authoritative HR system. If the agency utilizes the USA Staffing integration, the applicants may already have an existing selectee record, in which case the HR User verifies and updates the record as needed.

(b) Sponsorship

- 1 The earliest that Sponsorship can occur for Federal employees is after Tentative Offer Acceptance, however this is only possible for agencies that are participating in the USA Staffing 3rd party integration process.
- 2 The HSPD-12 Sponsor locates the Applicant's record in the appropriate HR system, selects the appropriate card type option (i.e., LincPass, AltLinc, No LincPass/AltLinc) and enters Card Shipping Information.

- 1 3 The Applicant will be automatically notified by e-mail from
2 hspd12admin@usaccess.gsa.gov with instructions on how to schedule an
3 appointment to enroll.
4

5 (c) Enrollment
6

- 7 1 The Applicant schedules an appointment time and location in the GSA
8 USAccess scheduling tool.
9
10 2 Upon the arrival of the Applicant to the enrollment station, the Registrar
11 locates and opens the Applicant's information and verifies the information
12 with the Applicant.
13
14 3 The Registrar validates and scans the Applicant's two identity source (I-9)
15 documents.
16
17 4 The Registrar obtains Applicant's fingerprints (rolls and slaps) and photo
18 and verifies that the Applicant's fingerprints can be matched to the
19 scanned images that will be used to create the biometric template.
20
21 5 The Registrar verifies all information is correct and complete, endorsing
22 with a digital signature.
23
24 6 The Registrar completes and saves Applicant's enrollment file.
25

26 (d) PIV Adjudication
27

- 28 1 The HSPD-12 Adjudicator releases the fingerprints on file from the
29 USAccess enrollment to the ISP, Defense Counterintelligence and
30 Security Agency (DCSA), for the completion of a Special Agreement
31 Check (SAC), also known as an FBI fingerprint check.
32
33 2 The HSPD-12 Adjudicator receives BI results from the ISP or the
34 suitability/fitness Adjudicator if they are not performing both duties.
35
36 3 The HSPD-12 Adjudicator enters PIV Adjudication results in the
37 authoritative HR system.
38

39 (e) Card Production and Issuance
40

- 41 1 Once the applicant has achieved an Active employment status and passed
42 all USAccess issuance rules, the credential can be issued either through
43 centralized or local printing.
44
45 2 Authoritative PIV Issuance System Centralized printing:
46

1 a Credentials are printed at GSA card production facility.

2
3 b Credentials are shipped to the designated shipping address.

4
5 3 USDA Local Printing:

6
7 a Credential is printed at a credentialing station with local print
8 capabilities.

9
10 (f) Activation

11
12 1 Activator verifies identity of Applicant.

13
14 2 The Activator retrieves the credential from locked storage. Note that hand
15 carried non-activated cards are not permitted by USDA unless the
16 Applicant has received approval from their Agency Lead and that Agency
17 Lead has contacted and coordinated the exception with the Activation
18 site's POC and/or the USDA HSPD-12 Agency Lead and has provided the
19 Applicant with a signed Chain-of-Trust letter.

20
21 3 Activator compares the picture on the credential with the Applicant and
22 provides the credential to the Applicant if they match. If the picture on the
23 credential does not match, the Activator contacts their Security Officer for
24 resolution.

25
26 4 If the Applicant biometric sample matches the biometric read from the
27 credential, the Applicant is authenticated to be the owner of the credential.
28 If the biometric sample does not match the biometric read from the
29 credential, the Activator contacts their Security Officer for resolution.

30
31 5 The Applicant uses the credential number and system-generated Personal
32 Identification Number (PIN; provided to Applicant in an e-mail) to log on
33 to the self-service activation web application.

34
35 6 The Applicant provides the primary fingerprint using the biometric card
36 reader for identity verification. A successful match will result in the
37 credential being unlocked. An unsuccessful match will result in an
38 Activator-assisted activation process. If the Activator-assisted activation
39 is unsuccessful, the Activator contacts the USAccess Help Desk.

40
41 7 The Endorsement screen appears requiring the Applicant's
42 acknowledgement of agreement to terms and conditions for receipt of the
43 credential.

44
45 8 The Applicant sets their new PIN which will be six to eight digits in
46 length.

1
2 9 The system encodes the credential with the digital certificates and will
3 display a confirmation when finished. The system will prompt the
4 Applicant to remove the LincPass from the smart card reader.
5

6 (g) LincPass Maintenance
7

8 1 The Sponsor maintains the cardholder's sponsorship information and
9 updates as needed.
10

11 2 Applicants perform certificate updates and card activations as prompted
12 by the USAccess system.
13

14 3 Sponsors will track and perform renewal and reissue actions to ensure
15 timely card refreshes prior to expiration.
16

17 4 The Security Officer can manually suspend or terminate cards based on
18 derogatory information, as well as reactivate cards as appropriate.
19

20 5 Physical Access Control System (PACS) and Logical Access Control
21 System (LACS) access are granted or revoked as appropriate.
22

23 6 The cardholder maintains their LincPass activity and renews certificates as
24 notified.
25

26 7 In the event a card becomes damaged or defective, cards must be returned
27 to the Agency Security Officer or mailed to USDA South Building –
28 OSSP FPD, 1400 Independence Ave SW, Rm 1408, Washington, DC
29 20250.
30

31 (2) Credential Protection
32

33 Mission Area, agency, or staff offices with active roles in the HSPD-12 processes
34 must ensure, at a minimum that the following items are secured in a lockable filing
35 cabinet within a secured office or space:
36

37 (a) Card stock.
38

39 (b) Credentials awaiting destruction.
40

41 (c) ID Credentials not in the personal custody of authorized user.
42

43 (d) In case of emergency evacuation, stored credentials should be relocated to an
44 alternate secure location.
45

12. USDA's HSPD-12 IMPLEMENTATION

USDA participates in the GSA Managed Service Office (MSO) USAccess program for issuance of the LincPass and AltLinc credentials. With the USAccess Program, the MSO offers a shared service that provides participating federal agencies and departments with all the key components necessary to manage the full lifecycle of a PIV credential. The service allows for a single authoritative PIV issuance system to sponsor, enroll, issue and maintain a common identity credential for each applicant, and includes built-in workflow processes at every stage of the credentialing process for USDA's LincPass credential.

GSA MSO's Shared Service Solution also includes Mobile and Fixed Credentialing Units as well as Light Activation Stations that provide USDA Mission Area, agency, or staff offices with the capability to complete credentialing services. USDA is responsible for maintaining and managing USDA's footprint for credentialing stations but can also leverage shared locations managed by outside federal agencies and departments.

Pricing of services is available on request from the [HSPD-12 Help Desk](#).

13. TEMPORARY CREDENTIALS

USDA has identified categories of individuals, temporary employees or non-Federal employees, guests, and occasional visitors, who do not meet the requirements for PIV. These individuals, however, may need credentials to gain access to facilities on an unaccompanied or escorted basis. Mission Area, agency, or staff offices may choose to implement stricter requirements at their own discretion.

a. Site Credential or Badge

A site credential is issued locally by the facility to persons that have met the adjudicative standards required who do not require a LincPass and do not require logical access but need unaccompanied physical access. Also, a site credential can be issued to individuals requiring a LincPass who have been favorably adjudicated and waiting for a LincPass credential to be issued. Refer to the USDA Credential Matrix for information regarding the issuance risk assessment. Issuers of site credentials or badges should utilize the [AD-1197](#) form.

b. Visitor Credential or Badge

A Visitor credential is issued locally to persons requiring temporary escorted physical access to controlled USDA facilities. Each USDA Mission Area, agency, or staff office will establish their own visitor procedures.

c. AltLinc Credential

- (1) USDA has implemented a PIV-I solution for individuals who are short-term Federal employees or non-Federal employees assigned to or associated with the Mission Area, agency, or staff offices requiring limited access to federally controlled facilities and/or information systems for fewer than 6 months. USDA's PIV-I credential has been named AltLinc, as it is an alternative credential to the existing LincPass credential.
- (2) The AltLinc will be issued using the same process as the LincPass, except for the minimum adjudicative standard. Since, the length of time to complete a T1 often exceeds the time a short-term employee or non-Federal employee would require access, an FBI Fingerprint check is the minimum required standard. In addition, the AltLinc process will leverage the existing roles that have been established for the LincPass process and is issued by the GSA USAccess service.

14. PIV USAGE

a. Physical Access Control Systems (PACS)

- (1) This summary outlines the strategic transition of the Electronic Physical Access Control System (ePACS) to meet the mandates of HSPD-12 and achieve FICAM (Federal Identity, Credential, and Access Management) compliance. The objective is to modernize the organization's physical security infrastructure by ensuring that all facility access points utilize secure, interoperable, and identity-validated credentials (PIV/CAC) in alignment with federal standards.

(a) Core Mandates

- 1 HSPD-12 (Homeland Security Presidential Directive 12): Requires a common identification standard for federal employees and contractors. This is realized through the PIV (Personal Identity Verification) card, which provides a secure, reliable form of identification.
- 2 FICAM Compliance: The roadmap for implementing HSPD-12. It ensures that the ePACS can not only read a card but also validate its authenticity against the issuing authority's infrastructure in real-time.

(b) Key Components of a FICAM-Compliant ePACS

- 1 To achieve compliance, the ePACS must integrate three primary technological layers:
 - a Identity Management (IDMS): Managing the lifecycle of the identity (onboarding, vetting, and card issuance).

- b Validation System: A backend service that performs a Certificate Revocation List (CRL) or Online Certificate Status Protocol (OCSP) check to ensure the card has not been revoked or expired.
- c Physical Access Control (PACS): The hardware (readers, panels) and software that grant or deny entry based on the validation results.

Table 6 - ePACS Compliance Requirements

Component	Requirement for Compliance
Card Readers	Must support transparent mode and be listed on the GSA Approved Products List (APL) .
Authentication	Must support PKI-based authentication (CHUID, PIV Auth, and/or CAK).
Interoperability	Must accept valid PIV/CAC credentials from other federal agencies without re-badging.

(c) Critical Benefits

- 1 Enhanced Security: Eliminates the risks associated with easily cloned legacy cards (e.g., 125kHz Proximity cards).
 - 2 Interoperability: Allows "trust but verify" access for visiting federal employees using their home agency credentials.
 - 3 Automation: Reduces manual administrative overhead by automatically disabling access when a credential is revoked at the source.
 - 4 Audit Readiness: Provides a standardized, defensible audit trail for federal oversight and compliance reviews.
- (2) In concurrence with HSPD-12's goal of rapid electronic authentication, USDA has developed and implemented a FIPS PUB 201-2 compliant enterprise Physical Access Control System (ePACS) infrastructure in order to rapidly provision and de-provision LincPasses (and all USDA issued electronic credentials) based on the PIV process. All authentication mechanism standards described in FIPS PUB 201-2 have been met by the ePACS as mandated by the OMB. As of October 2011, all USDA PACS must be HSPD-12 compliant and interface with the USDA ePACS infrastructure. Mission Area, agency, or staff office PACS must interface with the USDA ePACS through one of the following options:

- 1 (a) Integration Option A: HSPD-12 compatible Lenel Hardware and Software that
2 communicates directly with the USDA ePACS Lenel Infrastructure.
3
- 4 (b) Integration Option B: Non-Lenel HSPD-12 compatible systems that are made
5 to communicate with the USDA ePACS Lenel infrastructure using middleware
6 or similar technology.
7
- 8 (c) Integration Option C: Non-Lenel HSPD-12 compatible systems that do not
9 communicate with the USDA ePACS, but have a verified connection to an
10 authoritative personnel database or data feed.
11
- 12 (3) If Integration Option B or C is selected, a full cost benefit analysis must be
13 completed prior to procurement of the PACS equipment. This cost benefit analysis
14 must take into account all facets of the PACS installation, including Infrastructure
15 Hardware costs, Infrastructure Licensing Costs, undergoing full Security
16 Assessment and Authorization (SA&A), receiving Authorization to Operate (ATO),
17 *Federal Information Security Modernization Act* (FISMA) Audit and Reporting of
18 the PACS System, authoritative database, feed, and middleware development and
19 maintenance costs and PACS Infrastructure support costs. This cost benefit
20 analysis must be submitted the ePACS PMO for review as well as the Mission Area
21 Assistant Chief Information Officer (CIO) and the ePACS Agency Segment
22 Administrator (ASA) for approval.
23
- 24 (4) Any Mission Area, agency, or staff office facility with a PACS should have met the
25 mandated deadline of October 2011 for full compliance. The only non-compliant
26 PACS within USDA which do not interface with ePACS will be legacy systems
27 installed prior this deadline. Once these systems have reached end of life, they
28 must be replaced with an HSPD-12 compliant system as defined in [OMB](#)
29 [Memorandum M-19-17](#).
30
- 31 (5) All USDA Mission Area, agency, or staff offices must establish implementation
32 plans for the following scenarios at USDA leased and owned facilities:
33
- 34 (a) Converting an existing PACS to meet compliance.
35
- 36 (b) Purchase and installation of a new compliant PACS.
37
- 38 (6) The ePACS program is governed by the USDA ePACS Change Control Board
39 (CCB) which is comprised of representatives from the OSSP Facility Protection
40 Division as well as the Mission Area Assistant CIO from each Mission Area,
41 agency, and staff office. Mission Area, agency, or staff office participation in the
42 ePACS program requires the establishment of an MOU between the Mission Area,
43 agency, or staff office and the PMO. The MOU defines Mission Area, agency, or
44 staff office responsibility as well as the identification of the Agency Segment
45 Administrators to serve as the liaison between the Mission Area, agency, or staff
46 office and the PMO.

- 1
2 (7) To participate in the ePACS program, Mission Area, agency, or staff office
3 hardware must comply with the hardware and network requirements and
4 specifications defined in the ePACS documentation. For copies of this
5 documentation please contact the OSSP FPD at usdahspd12help@usda.gov.
6
- 7 (8) Procedures for integrating PACS into ePACS are as follows:
8
- 9 (a) Contact the ePACS PMO before the integration of an existing PACS or new
10 PACS installation for pre-planning and implementation guidance.
11
- 12 (b) If using Integration Option B or C, then prior to procuring PACS hardware and
13 software for a new PACS installation the ePACS Cost Benefit Analysis
14 template spreadsheet should be filled out to ensure USDA Mission Area,
15 agency, or staff offices select the most cost-effective manner to meet HSPD-12
16 and ePACS compliance while meeting their operational security needs.
17 Contact the OSSP FPD at usdahspd12help@usda.gov for a copy of this
18 spreadsheet.
19
- 20 (c) Notify the ePACS PMO of any PACS-related hardware and software that is
21 involved in the integration with ePACS or planned to be added to ensure
22 budget numbers are captured for software licensing for the following fiscal
23 year.
24
- 25 (d) Vendors chosen to support USDA PACS facilities must be GSA approved
26 HSPD-12 integrators, which are listed on the *Approved Products List* (APL).
27 Review and comply with the GSA APL when ordering PACS hardware or
28 software or services (integrators). The current APL is located at GSA, [FIPS](#)
29 [201 Evaluation Program](#) website.
30
- 31 (e) Chosen PACS must meet HSPD-12 compliance and interoperability
32 requirements as well as ePACS requirements.
33
- 34 (f) If using Integration Option A, all USDA Mission Area, agency, or staff offices
35 must submit all ePACS Change Management Requests through their ePACS
36 ASA member. Please contact the ePACS Help Desk at 1-833-682-4675 for
37 Mission Area, agency, or staff office POC information or assistance.
38
- 39 (g) If using Integration Options B or C the compliant PACS must undergo the
40 SA&A process with security assessments according to NIST, [SP 800-53 Rev.](#)
41 [5](#), *Security and Privacy Controls for Information Systems and Organizations*, if
42 they are not integrated into the ePACS. Contact the OCIO Information
43 Security Center (ISC) office for SA&A requirements and deadlines.
44
- 45 (9) Allowing non-USDA Mission Area, agency, or staff office PIV credentials in
46 ePACS:

- 1
2 (a) Each Mission Area, agency, or staff office makes an access rights and privilege
3 determination based on the non-USDA individual's need for electronic
4 physical access (e.g., detail to USDA; co-located space).
5

6 If access is determined to be needed, the PIV credential must be manually
7 enrolled in ePACS as defined in ePACS documentation. For copies of this
8 documentation please contact the OSSP FPD at usdahspd12help@usda.gov.
9

- 10 (b) De-provisioning of the cards will also be a manual process until all Certificate
11 Revocation Lists (CRLs) can be pushed down to ePACS. The manual de-
12 provisioning process can be obtained by contacting the OSSP FPD at
13 usdahspd12help@usda.gov.
14

15 b. Logical Access Control Systems (LACS)
16

- 17 (1) PIV operations consist of the technical interoperability requirements of HSPD-12,
18 specifically, the technical infrastructure for providing interoperable credentials for
19 Federal employees and non-Federal employees. All authentication mechanisms
20 described in FIPS PUB 201-3 are to be met with the use of integrated circuit cards.
21 As part of the GSA USAccess program, USDA is included in the USAccess System
22 of Records Notice (SORN), Federal Personal Identity Verification Identity
23 Management System (PIV IDMS).
24
- 25 (2) FIPS PUB 201-3 describes minimum technical requirements for the PIV-compliant
26 credentials. These requirements include interfacing specifications, cryptographic
27 specifications, Public Key Infrastructure (PKI) and certificate specifications, card
28 topology specifications, and biometric data specifications. The PIV-compliant
29 credentials issued will be used to control physical access to all federally controlled
30 facilities and logical access to all federally controlled information systems through a
31 contact or contactless interface.
32
- 33 (3) See [DR 3640-001](#) for guidance related to logical access.
34
- 35 (4) See [DR 3505-003](#), *Access Control for Information and Information Systems*, for
36 guidance related to exceptions to card utilization for logical access. Additionally,
37 there is a "Waiver Request for Long-Term Expiration" template available for
38 Mission Area, agency, or staff offices to request logical access waivers.
39
- 40 (5) USDA personnel with an active LincPass are eligible for Derived PIV credentials as
41 part of the MobileLinc program if they have been assigned an authorized mobile
42 device registered with the USDA Enterprise Mobility Management (EMM). Refer
43 to ICAM's Personal Identity Verification Derived Credentials Issuing Operations
44 Plan for more information. You can also obtain additional information at the
45 [USDA MobileLinc Credential Portal website](#).
46

1
2 15. INQUIRIES
3

4 Questions regarding this DM should be directed to OSSP at 202-690-6777 or
5 securityservicehelp@usda.gov.
6

7
8 -END

1 APPENDIX A

2
3 ACRONYMS AND ABBREVIATIONS

4

5

6	ACL	Access Control List
7	AD	Agriculture Department (Prefix for Departmental Forms)
8	AGAR	Agriculture Acquisition Regulation
9	APL	Approved Products List
10	ASA	Agency Segment Administrator
11	ATO	Authorization to Operate
12	BI	Background Investigation
13	CBP	U.S. Customs and Border Protection (DHS Component)
14	CFR	Code of Federal Regulations
15	CIO	Chief Information Officer
16	CO	Contracting Officer
17	COR	Contracting Officer's Representative
18	CVS	Central Verification System
19	DCSA	Defense Counterintelligence and Security Agency
20	DCSA/NS	Defense Counterintelligence and Security Agency/National Security
21	DG	Departmental Guidebook
22	DHS	Department of Homeland Security
23	DM	Departmental Manual
24	DPCI	Derived PIV Credential Issuers
25	DPI	Dots Per Inch
26	DR	Departmental Regulation
27	EAD	Enterprise Active Directory
28	eAPP	Electronic Application
29	EMM	Enterprise Mobility Management
30	E.O.	Executive Order
31	ePACS	Enterprise Physical Access Control System
32	ERT	Emergency Response Team
33	FA	Facility Administrator
34	FAR	Federal Acquisition Regulation
35	FBI	Federal Bureau of Investigation
36	FBI NCHC	Federal Bureau of Investigation National Criminal History Check
37	FD	Federal Database
38	FERO	Federal Emergency Response Official
39	FIPS PUB	Federal Information Processing Standards Publication
40	FISMA	Federal Information Security Modernization Act
41	FPD	Facility Protection Division (OSSP Component)
42	GSA	General Services Administration
43	HR	Human Resources
44	HSPD-12	Homeland Security Presidential Directive 12
45	ICAM	Identity, Credential, and Access Management
46	ID	Identification

1	IDMS	Identity Management System
2	ISC	Information Security Center (OCIO Component)
3	ISP	Investigative Service Provider
4	IT	Information Technology
5	LACS	Logical Access Control System
6	LMS	Learning Management System
7	MOU	Memorandum of Understanding
8	MSO	Managed Service Office
9	NAC	National Agency Check
10	NACI	National Agency Check with (Written) Inquiries
11	NCR	National Capital Region
12	NFC	National Finance Center
13	NIST	National Institute of Standards and Technology
14	OCIO	Office of the Chief Information Officer
15	OF	Optional Form
16	OFI	Office of Federal Investigations
17	OHS	Office of Homeland Security
18	OIG	Office of the Inspector General
19	OMB	Office of Management and Budget
20	OPM	Office of Personnel Management
21	OSSP	Office of Safety, Security, and Protection
22	PACS	Physical Access Control System
23	PCI	Personal Identity Verification Card Issuers
24	PDF	Portable Data File
25	PDSO	Personnel and Document Security Division (OHS Component)
26	PIN	Personal Identification Number
27	PIV	Personal Identity Verification
28	PIV-D	Personal Identity Verification Derived
29	PIV-I	Personal Identity Verification Interoperable
30	PIV IDMS	Personal Identity Verification Identity Management System
31	PKI	Public Key Infrastructure
32	P.L.	Public Law
33	PM	Program Manager
34	PMO	Program Management Office
35	POC	Point of Contact
36	PRA	Paperwork Reduction Act
37	SA&A	Security Assessment and Authorization
38	SAC	Special Agreement Check
39	SAVE	Systematic Alien Verification for Entitlements
40	SF	Standard Form
41	SORN	System of Records Notice
42	SP	Special Publication
43	SSN	Social Security Number
44	SWF	Small Web Format
45	T1	Tier One
46	U.S.C.	United States Code

1	USCIS	U.S. Citizenship and Immigration Services (DHS Component)
2	USDA	United States Department of Agriculture
3	VPN	Virtual Private Network

1 APPENDIX B

2
3 DEFINITIONS

4
5
6 Appendix B provides the definitions for terms and terminology used throughout this document.
7 The following definitions are derived from relevant policies and guidance.

8
9 Access control. The process of granting or denying requests to access physical facilities or areas,
10 or to logical systems (e.g., computer networks or software applications). See also “logical access
11 control system” and “physical access control system.”

12
13 Access (Routine). Entry into and use of a facility and/or information system on a regular basis
14 without an escort and/or continuous monitoring by a USDA official. The Mission Area, agency,
15 and staff office determination should be based upon the support to successfully complete USDA’s
16 mission functions. Routine access requires a mandatory PIV or PIV-I credential to be issued.

17
18 Access (Unaccompanied). Entry into and use of a facility and/or information system without an
19 escort and/or continuous monitoring by a USDA official. The Mission Area, agency, and staff
20 office’s determination for unaccompanied access should be based upon the support to
21 successfully complete USDA’s mission functions. Unaccompanied access requires a mandatory
22 LincPass to be issued.

23
24 AD-1197 Form. Request for USDA Identification (ID) Badge form.

25
26 AltLinc. USDA has named their common identity PIV-I card the AltLinc, as it is designed to link
27 a person’s identity to an identification card and the card to a person’s ability to access Federal
28 buildings and computer systems. This card will be used to service short-term personnel (less than
29 6 months) and personnel who fail to meet the HSPD-12 minimum investigative requirements. The
30 spelling of the AltLinc PIV-I card is derived from the word alternative as it is meant to serve as an
31 alternative to the LincPass.

32
33 Authorization. The official management decision given by a senior organizational official to
34 authorize operation of an information system and to explicitly accept the risk to the organizational
35 operations (including mission, functions, image, or reputation), organizational assets, individuals,
36 other organizations, and the nation, based on the implementation of an agreed-upon set of security
37 controls. (Source: NIST, [Glossary](#), Retrieved May 3, 2021)

38
39 Barring. Prevention of entry onto federal property.

40
41 Biometric. A measurable physical characteristic used to recognize the identity of an individual.
42 Examples include fingerprints, and facial images. A biometric system uses biometric data for
43 authentication purposes.

44
45 Contractor. An individual under contract to USDA (for the purpose of HSPD-12
46 implementation).

1
2 eAPP. The Electronic Questionnaires for Investigations Processing is a Defense
3 Counterintelligence and Security Agency (DCSA) system that allows for the secure transmission
4 of security questionnaires between government agencies and DCSA.

5
6 eAuthentication. The process of establishing an individual's identity and determining whether
7 individual Federal employees or contractors are who they say they are.

8
9 Employee. Defined in 5 U.S.C. § 2105 "Employee," within a department or agency. "Employee"
10 means a person, other than the President and Vice President, employed by, detailed or assigned to,
11 USDA, including members of the Armed Forces; an expert or consultant to USDA; an industrial
12 or commercial contractor, licensee, certificate holder, or grantee of USDA, including all
13 subcontractors; or any other category of person who acts on behalf of an agency as determined by
14 the agency head

15
16 EmpowHR. An Oracle People Soft-based Human Capital Management System, EmpowHR is an
17 integrated suite of commercial and Government applications that can be leveraged to automate
18 common administrative tasks associated with HR management and reduce internal operational
19 costs using industry best practices. EmpowHR is used by several USDA Mission Areas,
20 agencies, or staff offices.

21
22 ePACS. An Enterprise Physical Access Control System to centralize and provide a means to
23 distribute identity data related to LincPass credentialed individuals to all USDA PACS.

24
25 ePACS Agency Segment Administrator (ASA). An ePACS ASA is the overall Mission Area,
26 agency, or staff office point of contact and liaison between the ePACS Program Management
27 Office (PMO) and the segment's Facility Administrators (FA) and end users. The ePACS ASA is
28 responsible for monitoring the status of a Mission Area, agency, or staff office ePACS
29 segment(s), attending CCB Meetings, a semi-annual user account review, assisting in distribution
30 and communication of software upgrades, and system disruptions to their user base, processing
31 Change Requests and User Account creation/change requests for said segments, and escalating
32 system issues and problems from the FA to the ePACS PMO as needed

33
34 Executive Order 10450. Security Requirements for Government Employees.

35
36 Facility Administrator (FA). A Facility Administrator is the overall agency POC and liaison
37 between the ePACS ASA and the segment's end users, including Credential Operators and Site
38 Guards. The FA is responsible for escalating system issues and problems from the Credential
39 Operators and Site Guards to the ePACS ASA as needed.

40
41 Federal Bureau of Investigation (FBI) Fingerprint Check. FBI National Criminal History Check.
42 This check is an integral part of the T1 and is the minimum requirement for PIV ID credential
43 issuance.

44
45 FD-258 Form. Fingerprint Chart used to conduct contractor FBI fingerprint checks.

1 Federal Facility or Information System Access. Authorization granted to an individual to
2 physically enter federally controlled facilities, and to electronically (logically) access federally
3 controlled information systems for approved purposes.

4
5 Identity Management System (IDMS). One or more systems or applications that manage the
6 identity verification, validation and issuance process. The IDMS software is used by PIV
7 Registrars to enroll Applicants.

8
9 Identity-proofing. The process of providing sufficient information (e.g., driver's license, proof of
10 current address) to a registration authority, or the process of verifying an individual's information
11 that he or she is that individual and no other.

12
13 Lenel OnGuard. The OnGuard application vendor, Lenel, offers advanced access control, alarm
14 monitoring, digital video, intrusion detection, asset tracking, information security integration,
15 credential production, and employee and visitor management functionality in an enterprise
16 structure for data redundancy and data segregation by Mission Area, agency, or staff office and
17 location.

18
19 Limited Access. Limited access to facilities includes unaccompanied access to general common
20 areas and workspace only. Limited access to information systems includes access to applications
21 such as USDA email, Time & Attendance, AgLearn, and Concur.

22
23 LincPass. USDA has named their common ID card the LincPass, as it is designed to link a
24 person's identity to an identification card and the card to a person's ability to access Federal
25 buildings and computer systems. The spelling of LincPass is a tribute to President Abraham
26 Lincoln, who created USDA, also known as the People's Department, in 1862.

27
28 Logical Access Control System (LACS). A protection mechanism that limits a user's access to
29 information and restricts their type of access to only what is appropriate for them. These systems
30 may be built into an operating system, application, or an added system.

31
32 National Capital Region (NCR). This is comprised of the District of Columbia; Montgomery and
33 Prince Georges counties, Maryland; the cities of Alexandria, Fairfax and Falls Church, Virginia;
34 and Fairfax, Arlington, Loudoun, and Prince William counties, Virginia.

35
36 Non-Federal employee. A person with a relationship with the USDA other than employment,
37 such as through a contract, grant, agreement, or memorandum of understanding, doing work for
38 or on behalf of the USDA, such as a contractor, affiliate, fellow, intern, or volunteer.

39
40 OF-306 Form. Declaration for Federal Employment.

41
42 OPM OFI-79A Form. Report of Agency Adjudicator Action on OPM Personnel Investigations.

43
44 Person Model. Common name for EmpowHR Non-Employee Processing module. USDA's
45 secure and authoritative database for USDA identities and non-Federal employee information
46 required by HSPD-12. Person Model is a module of EmpowHR that feeds non-Federal employee

1 information to the authoritative PIV issuance system, the General Services Administration (GSA)
2 credentialing system. Sponsorship and Adjudication information for non-Federal employees is
3 entered directly into Person Model.
4

5 Physical Access Control System (PACS). Protection mechanisms that limit a user's access to
6 physical facilities or areas to only what is appropriate for them. These systems typically involve a
7 combination of hardware and software (e.g., a card reader), and may involve human control (e.g.,
8 a security guard)
9

10 PIV Compliant Credential. An identity card ("smart card") also known as LincPass issued to an
11 individual that contains stored identity credentials so that the claimed identity of the cardholder
12 can be verified against the stored credentials by another person or by an automated process.
13

14 Public Key Infrastructure (PKI). A set of policies, processes, server platforms, software and
15 workstations used for the purpose of administering certificates and public-private key pairs,
16 including the ability to issue, maintain, and revoke public key certificates. (Source: DG 0100-
17 002)
18

19 Revocation. Referring to the termination of a credential. This refers to both the physical removal
20 of the card from the cardholder's possession and the electronic shut off of physical and logical
21 access.
22

23 Routine access. A person that is accessing the facility or information system without an escort or
24 continuous monitoring by a USDA official. The Mission Area, agency, or staff office
25 determination should be based upon the support to successfully complete USDA's mission critical
26 functions and missions. This type of access requires a mandatory PIV ID credential to be issued.
27

28 Standard Form (SF)-85. OPM Questionnaire for Non-Sensitive Positions.
29

30 Standard Form (SF)-85P. OPM Questionnaire for Public Trust Positions.
31

32 Standard Form (SF)-86. OPM Questionnaire for National Security Positions.
33

34 Standard Form (SF)-87. Fingerprint Chart used to conduct FBI fingerprint checks for federal
35 appointees and employees and Applicants for Federal employment.
36

37 Site Credential. A credential issued locally by the facility to persons that do not need a LincPass
38 but need access to the facility or information system to conduct temporary work.
39

40 Short Term Employee. Temporary, Term, Student, or intern with employment less than 6 months
41 that are paid or obtaining some sort of benefit directly from USDA.
42

43 Suspension. Referring to the temporary shut off of physical and logical access to the credential
44 without terminating the card issuance.
45

1 Tier 1 (T1) Investigation. Formerly National Agency Check and Inquiries (NACI)), for positions
2 designated as low risk, non-sensitive, and for physical and/or logical access.
3

4 USDA Credential Matrix. The tool to determine a person's legitimate need for physical or logical
5 access using a PIV or other types of credentials as outlined in HSPD-12 to USDA facilities and
6 information systems, and the requirement to view sensitive information.
7

8 Visitor. An individual (typically not a federal or non-federal employee to USDA) who enters a
9 federal facility for time-bound and/or purpose-specific visit and does not require credentials or
10 authorizations for routine access.
11

12 Volunteer. Under 7 U.S.C. § 2272, a volunteer is defined as an individual who willingly (without
13 duress or intimidation) offers or agrees to provide his or her time or services without
14 compensation, and who performs those services in a manner that contributes to the furtherance of
15 the programs of USDA Mission Area, agency, or staff offices.

1 APPENDIX C

2
3 AUTHORITIES AND REFERENCES
4
5

6 The processes and procedures outlined in this DM align with the directives and standards that are
7 listed below:
8

9 [5 CFR Part 315](#), *Career and Career-Conditional Employment*, Subpart H (Probationary
10 Employees)
11

12 [5 CFR Part 731](#), *Suitability*, Subparts D and E
13

14 [5 CFR Part 752](#), *Adverse Actions*, Subparts D through F
15

16 [7 CFR § 2.94](#), *Chief Security Director, Office of Safety, Security, and Protection*
17

18 [7 CFR § 2.95](#), *Director, Office of Homeland Security*
19

20 [5 U.S.C. § 2105](#), *Employee*
21

22 [7 U.S.C. § 2272](#), *Volunteers for Department of Agriculture programs*
23

24 [44 U.S.C. § 3552\(b\)\(6\)\(A\)](#), *Definitions; National security System*
25

26 Agriculture Acquisition Regulation (AGAR) 404.13, *Personal Identity Verification*,
27 <https://www.acquisition.gov/agar>
28

29 CBP, Form [I-94](#), *Arrival/Departure Record*
30

31 *E-Government Act of 2002*, [44 U.S.C. § 3501](#), December 17, 2002, as amended
32

33 [E.O. 10450](#), *Security Requirements for Government Employees*, April 27, 1953
34

35 [E.O. 12968](#), *Access to Classified Information*, August 2, 1995
36

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APPENDIX D

Table 7 - USDA CREDENTIAL MATRICES

LincPass Matrix for U.S. Nationals

USDA Credential Name	Credential Type	Standard Usage	BI Level Required	Issuer
LincPass	HSPD-12 Compliant Personal Identity Verification (PIV)	Long term (6 months or greater) employees and non-Federal employees requiring routine access to federal facilities or information systems.	Interim Determination: FBI Fingerprint Check & Scheduled Tier 1 (minimum) Final Determination: Tier 1 (minimum)	USAccess
AltLinc	PIV Interoperable (PIV-I)	Short-term (less than 6 months) employees and non-Federal employees requiring routine access to federal facilities or information systems.	FBI Fingerprint Check (minimum)	USAccess
Site Badge	Proximity/CIV Card	1. New employees/contractors awaiting the issuance of a PIV requiring unescorted physical access. 2. Unescorted physical access for short-term intermittent access.	FBI Fingerprint Check (minimum)	Mission Area, agency, staff office
Visitor Badge	PVC/Proximity/CIV Card/Sticker	Escorted access for visitors to a facility. Not intended for regular/routine access for federal and non-federal employees.	None	Local Site
ID Badge	Non-PIV Agency Managed Credentials	As defined in DR 4620-002 – Section 3C - Law Enforcement, Food Inspection, Animal Care, Protective Detail, etc... Not applicable for physical or logical access.	Agency Specified	Mission Area, agency, staff office
MobileLinc	PIV Derived (PIV-D)	Logical access only. Requires PIV for issuance. A digital credential stored electronically on mobile device.	Interim: FBI Fingerprint Check & Scheduled Tier 1 (minimum) Final: Minimum Tier 1	OCIO
Alt MFA	Alternate Multi-Factor Authentication Credentials (Yubikey/Windows Hello for Business)	Logical access only. Usage for alternate authentication when PIV is unavailable.	Refer to BI requirements for Active Directory accounts in DR 3505-003	OCIO

LincPass Matrix for Non-U.S. Nationals

USDA Credential Name	Credential Type	Standard Usage	BI Level Required	Issuer
LincPass	HSPD-12 Compliant Personal Identity Verification (PIV)	Long term (6 months or greater) employees and non-Federal employees requiring routine access to federal facilities or information systems.	Fully adjudicated Tier 1 (minimum) or equivalent Background Investigation and Employment Authorization Verification based on the investigative standards identified in DM 4620-002 Section 6(2)a NOTE: Issuance under Interim Determination is generally not permitted for non-U.S. Nationals except for exempted categories of FNs considered US Persons in US locations that meet the residency standards for a BI	USAccess
AltLinc	PIV Interoperable (PIV-I)	1. Facility access card for Non-U.S. Nationals unable to meet investigative standards for PIV Tier 1 BI residing in U.S. based locations or U.S. Territories until the 3-year time in U.S. or U.S. Territory can be met and a BI can be completed. 2. Facility access card for non-U.S. Nationals in foreign locations unable to meet investigative standards for Tier 1 BI	1. Investigative standards identified in DM 4620-002 Section 6(2)a 2. Investigative standards identified in DM 4620-002 Section 6(2)a and approval by the Director of the USDA Office of Homeland Security and Under Secretary or responsible Mission Area, Agency, or Staff Office head.	USAccess

USDA Credential Name	Credential Type	Standard Usage	BI Level Required	Issuer
Site Badge	Proximity/CIV Card	1. Fully vetted new employees/contractors awaiting the issuance of a PIV requiring unescorted physical access.	1. Fully adjudicated Tier 1 (minimum) or equivalent Background Investigation and Employment Authorization Verification based on the investigative standards identified in DM 4620-002 Section 6(2)a	Mission Area, agency, staff office
Visitor Badge	PVC/Proximity/ CIV Card/Sticker	1. Escorted access for visitors to a facility. Not intended for regular/routine access for federal and non-federal employees.	1. Coordination through the OHS Foreign National Visitor program	Local Site

APPENDIX E

EXAMPLES OF CREDENTIAL TOPOLOGIES

1. FRONT REQUIREMENTS OF PIV CREDENTIAL

a. Mandatory Items on the Front of the PIV Card

- (1) Zone 1F – Photograph. The photograph must be placed in the upper left corner and be a full-frontal pose from top of the head to shoulder. A minimum of 300 dots per inch (dpi) resolution must be used. The background should follow recommendations set forth in [SP 800-76-2](#), *Biometric Specifications for Personal Identity Verification*.
- (2) Zone 2F – Name. The full name must be printed directly under the photograph in capital letters. The full name must be composed of a Primary Identifier (i.e., surnames or family names) and a Secondary Identifier (i.e., pre-names or given names). The printed name must match the name on the identity source documents provided during identity proofing and registration to the extent possible. The full name must be printed in the <Primary Identifier>, <Secondary Identifier>, format. The entire full name should be printed on available lines of Zone 2F and either identifier could be wrapped. The wrapped identifier must be indicated with “>” character at the end of the line. The identifiers may be printed on separate lines if each fits on one line. Departments and agencies must use the largest font size of 7 to 10-points that allows the full name to be printed. The font size 7-point allows space for 3 lines and must only be used if the full name does not fit on two lines with font size 8-point.
- (3) Zone 8F – Employee Affiliation. An employee affiliation must be printed on the card. Some examples of employee affiliation are “Employee,” “Contractor,” “Active Duty,” and “Civilian.”
- (4) Zone 10F – Agency, Department, or Organization. The organizational affiliation must be printed as depicted in Figure 3, *Front of PIV Credential*.
- (5) Zone 14F – Card Expiration Date. The card expiration date must be printed on the card. The card expiration date must be in a YYYYMMDD format whereby the MMM characters represent the three-letter month abbreviation as follows: JAN, FEB, MAR, APR, MAY, JUN, JUL, AUG, SEP, OCT, NOV, and DEC. The Zone 14F expiration date must be printed in Arial 6 to 9-point bold.
- (6) Zone 15F – Color-Coding for Employee Affiliation. Color-coding must be used for additional identification of employee affiliation as a background color for Zone 2F (name). The following color scheme must be used:

1 (a) Blue – Foreign National

2
3 (b) White – Government Employee

4
5 (c) Green – Contractor

6
7 Foreign National color-coding has precedence over Government Employee and
8 Contractor color-coding. These colors must be reserved and must not be employed
9 for other purposes. Zone 15F may be a solid or patterned line at the Department or
10 agency's discretion.

11
12 (7) Zone 18F – Affiliation Color Code. The affiliation color code “B” for Blue, “W”
13 for White, or “G” for Green must be printed in a white circle in Zone 15F. The
14 diameter of the circle must not be more than 5 mm. Note that the lettering must
15 correspond to the printed color in Zone 15F.

16
17 (8) Zone 19F – Card Expiration Date. The card expiration date must be printed in a
18 MMMYYYY format in the upper right-hand corner. The Zone 19F expiration date
19 must be printed in Arial 12-point Bold.

20
21 b. Optional Items on the Front of the PIV Card – Available through the GSA USAccess
22 Program

23
24 (1) Zone 4F – Agency Specific Text Area. If used, this area can be used for printing
25 agency specific requirements, such as employee status.

26
27 (2) Zone 5F – Rank. If used, the cardholder's rank must be printed in this area. Data
28 format is at the Department or agency's discretion.

29
30 (3) Zone 9F – Header. If used, the text “United States Government” must be placed as
31 depicted in Figure 3. Departments and agencies may also choose to use this zone
32 for other Department or agency-specific information, such as identifying a Federal
33 emergency responder role.

34
35 (4) Zone 11F – Agency Seal. If used, the seal selected by the issuing Department,
36 agency, or organization must be printed in the area depicted.

37
38 (5) Zone 12F – Footer. The footer is the location for the Federal Emergency Response
39 Official identification label. If used, a Department or agency may print “Federal
40 Emergency Response Official” as depicted in Figure 3, preferably in white lettering
41 on a red background. Departments and agencies may also use Zone 9F to further
42 identify the Federal emergency respondent's official role. Some examples of
43 official roles are “Law Enforcement,” “Fire Fighter,” and “Emergency Response
44 Team (ERT).” When Zone 15F indicates Foreign National affiliation and the
45 Department or agency does not need to highlight emergency response official
46 status, Zone 12F may be used to denote the country or countries of citizenship. If

so used, the Department or agency must print the country name or the three-letter country abbreviation (alpha-3 format).

- (6) Zone 17F – Agency Specific Data. In cases in which other defined optional elements are not used, Zone 17F may be used for other Department or agency-specific information.
- (7) Zone 20F – Organizational Affiliation Abbreviation. The organizational affiliation abbreviation may be printed in the upper right-hand corner below the Zone 19F expiration date. If printed, the organizational affiliation abbreviation must be printed in Arial 12-point Bold.

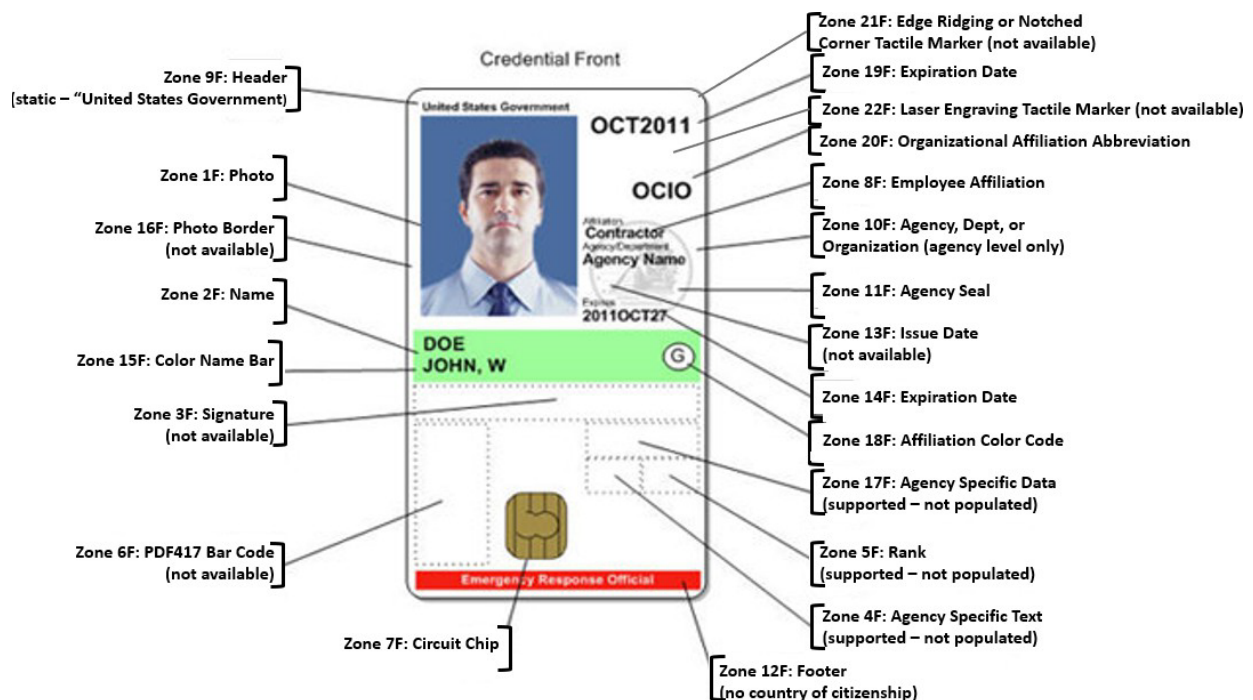
c. Optional Items on the Front of the PIV Card – Not Available through the GSA USAccess Program

- (1) Zone 3F – Signature. If used, the Department or agency must place the cardholder signature below the photograph and cardholder name. The space for the signature must not interfere with the contact and contactless placement. Because of card surface space constraints, placement of a signature may limit the size of the optional two-dimensional bar code.
- (2) Zone 6F – Portable Data File (PDF) Two-Dimensional Bar Code. If used, the PDF bar code placement must be as depicted in Figure 3 (i.e., left side of the card). If Zone 3F (a cardholder signature) is used, the size of the PDF bar code may be affected. The card issuer should confirm that a PDF used in conjunction with a PIV Card containing a cardholder signature will satisfy the anticipated PDF data storage requirements.
- (3) Zone 13F – Issue Date. If used, the card issuance date must be printed above the Zone 14F expiration date in YYYYMMDD format.
- (4) Zone 16F – Photo Border. A border may be used with the photo to further identify employee affiliation. This border may be used in conjunction with Zone 15F to enable Departments and agencies to develop various employee categories. The photo border must not obscure the photo. The border may be a solid or patterned line. For solid and patterned lines, red must be reserved for emergency response officials, blue for foreign nationals, and green for contractors. All other colors may be used at the Department or agency's discretion.
- (5) Zone 21F – Edge Ridging or Notched Corner Tactile Marker. If used, this area must incorporate edge ridging or a notched corner to indicate card orientation. Departments and agencies should ensure such alterations are closely coordinated with the card vendor or manufacturer to ensure the card material integrity and printing process is not adversely impacted.

- (6) Zone 22F –Laser Engraving Tactile Marker. If used, tactilely discernible marks must be created using laser engraving to indicate card orientation. There must be an opening in the lamination foil where laser engraving is performed. Departments and agencies should ensure such alterations are closely coordinated with the card vendor or manufacturer to ensure the card material integrity and printing process is not adversely impacted.

Figure 3, *Front of PIV Credential*, below provides a graphic copy of the front of a PIV Credential Badge and explanation of the zones.

FIGURE 3 – Front of PIV Credential



2. BACK REQUIREMENTS OF PIV CREDENTIAL

a. Mandatory Items on the Back of the PIV Card

- (1) Zone 1B – Agency Card Serial Number. This item must be printed as depicted in Figure 4, *Back of PIV Credential* and contain the unique serial number from the issuing Department or agency. The format is at the discretion of the issuing Department or agency.

- 1 (2) Zone 2B – Issuer Identification Number. This item must be printed as depicted in
2 Figure 4 and consist of six characters for the Department code, four characters for
3 the agency code, and a five-digit number that uniquely identifies the issuing facility
4 within the Department or agency.
5
- 6 b. Optional Items on the Back of the PIV Card – Available through the GSA USAccess
7 Program
8
- 9 (1) Zone 4B – Return Address. If used, the “return if lost” language must be generally
10 placed on the back of the card.
11
- 12 (2) Zone 5B – Physical Characteristics of Cardholder. If used, the cardholder physical
13 characteristics (e.g., height, eye color, hair color) must be printed in the general area
14 illustrated in Figure 4.
15
- 16 (3) Zone 7B – Standard Section 499, Title 18 Language. If used, standard Section 499,
17 Title 18, language warning against counterfeiting, altering, or misusing the card
18 must be printed in the general area depicted in Figure 4.
19
- 20 c. Optional Items on the Back of the PIV Card – Not Available through the GSA
21 USAccess Program
22
- 23 (1) Zone 3B – Magnetic Stripe. If used, the magnetic stripe must be high coercivity
24 and placed in accordance Figure 4.
25
- 26 (2) Zone 6B – Additional Language for Emergency Response Officials. Departments
27 and agencies may choose to provide additional information to identify emergency
28 response officials or to better identify the cardholder’s authorized access. If used,
29 this additional text must be in the general area depicted and must not interfere with
30 other printed text or machine-readable components.
31
- 32 (3) Zone 8B – Linear 3 of 9 Bar Code. If used, a linear 3 of 9 bar code must be
33 generally placed as depicted in Figure 4. It must be in accordance with Association
34 for Automatic Identification and Mobility (AIM) standards. Beginning and end
35 points of the bar code will be dependent on the embedded contactless module
36 selected. Departments and agencies are encouraged to coordinate placement of the
37 bar code with the card vendor.
38
- 39 (4) Zone 9B – Agency-Specific Text. In cases in which other defined optional
40 elements are not used, Zone 9B may be used for other Department or agency-
41 specific information. For example, emergency response officials may use this area
42 to provide additional details.
43
- 44 (5) Zone 10B – Agency-Specific Text. Zone 10 is similar to Zone 9 in that it is another
45 area for providing Department or agency-specific information. For Zones 9 and 10,
46 Departments and agencies are encouraged to use this area prudently and minimize

printed text to that which is absolutely necessary. In the case of the Department of Defense, the back of the card will have a distinct appearance. This is necessary to display information required by the Geneva Accord and to facilitate legislatively mandated medical entitlements.

Figure 4, *Back of PIV Credential*, below provides an example of the back of a PIV Credential Badge and explanation of badge zones.

FIGURE 4 – Back of PIV Credential

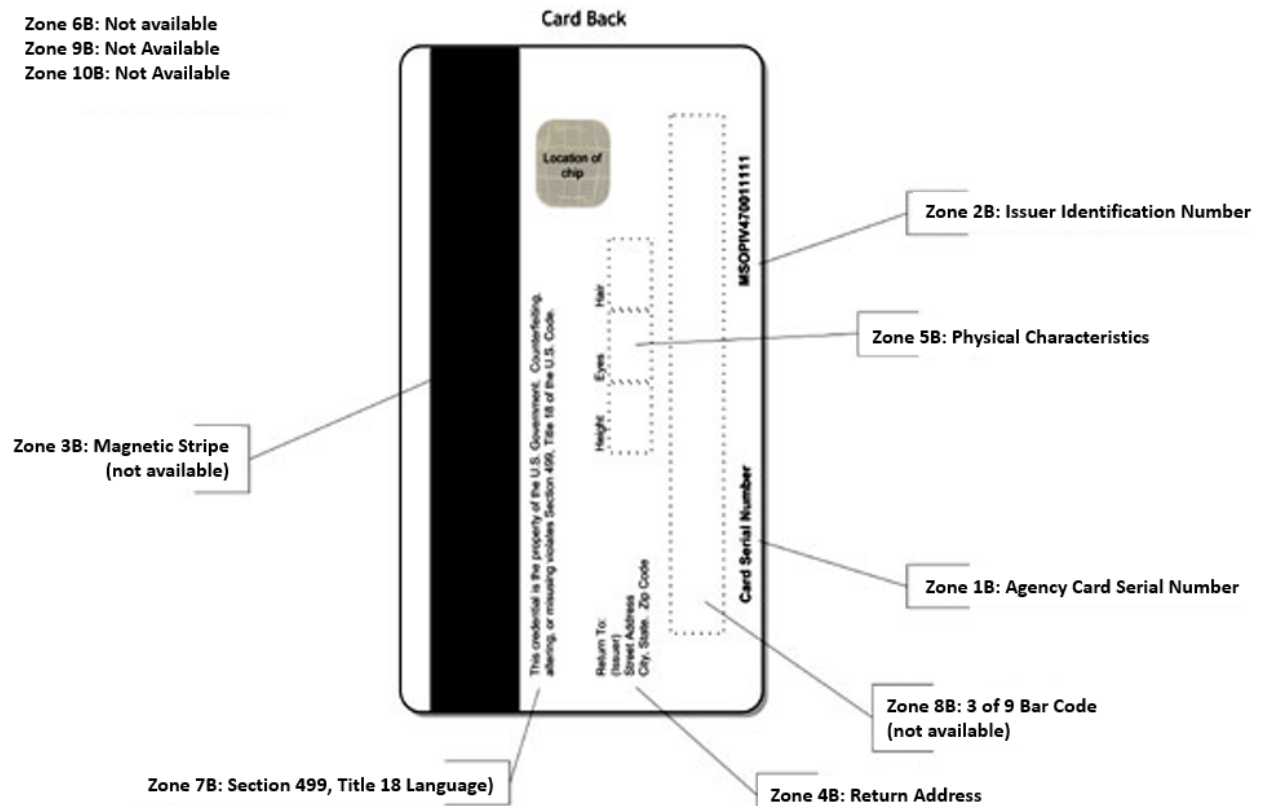


Figure 5, *LincPass Topology*, below provides an example of the LincPass topology. The LincPass name bar color coding is explained in the section below the LincPass badge.

FIGURE 5 – LincPass Topology



3. USDA LINCPASS NAME BAR COLOR CODING

- a. Coding for Federal Employee – White. An individual employed by, detailed to, or assigned to USDA under the authority of 5 U.S.C. § 2105, *Employee*, and receives Government funding for services rendered.
- b. Coding for USDA Affiliation – Contractors: Green. An individual under contract (i.e., prime or sub-contract) to USDA requiring routine unaccompanied access to USDA-controlled facilities and USDA-controlled information systems.
- c. Coding for USDA Affiliation – Associate or Dignitary: White. An individual under a grant or agreement to USDA requiring routine unaccompanied access to USDA-controlled facilities and USDA-controlled information systems.
- d. Coding for USDA Affiliation – Foreign National: Blue. An individual who is employed by, detailed to, or assigned to USDA but who is not a citizen or permanent resident alien of the U.S. The foreign national color coding takes precedence over the Federal Employee, Contractor, or Associate or Dignitary color designation.

- e. Coding for USDA Affiliation—Federal Emergency Response Official (FERO). A FERO will be annotated with a red band in the footer. Mission Area, agency, or staff offices are responsible for determining who should be authorized the coding of FERO.

Figure 6, *Site Credential Topology*, below provides an example of a Site Credential badge topology.

FIGURE 6 – Site Credential Topology

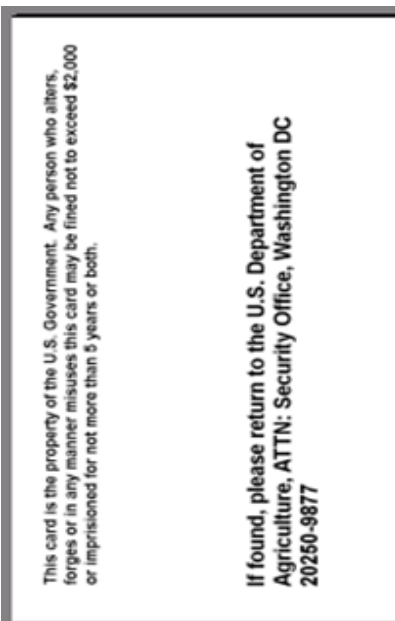


Figure 7, *Visitor Site Badge Topology*, below provides an example of USDA Visitor Site Badge topology.

FIGURE 7 – Visitor Site Badge Topology



Figure 8, *Paper Visitor Pass*, below provides an example of a paper Visitor Pass.

FIGURE 8 – Paper Visitor Pass

Colors distinguish the day of the week

Example

Escort Required Good only for date shown. To be turned in at guard's desk at the end of visit. USDA 	Visitor Pass	
	Name	THU
	Date	
	Post	
United States Department of Agriculture		

4. PIV-I TOPOLOGY

The PIV-I cards are visually different from a PIV card as shown below. PIV-I credential orientation is landscape vs. portrait orientation of PIV.

5. FRONT REQUIREMENTS OF PIV-I CREDENTIAL

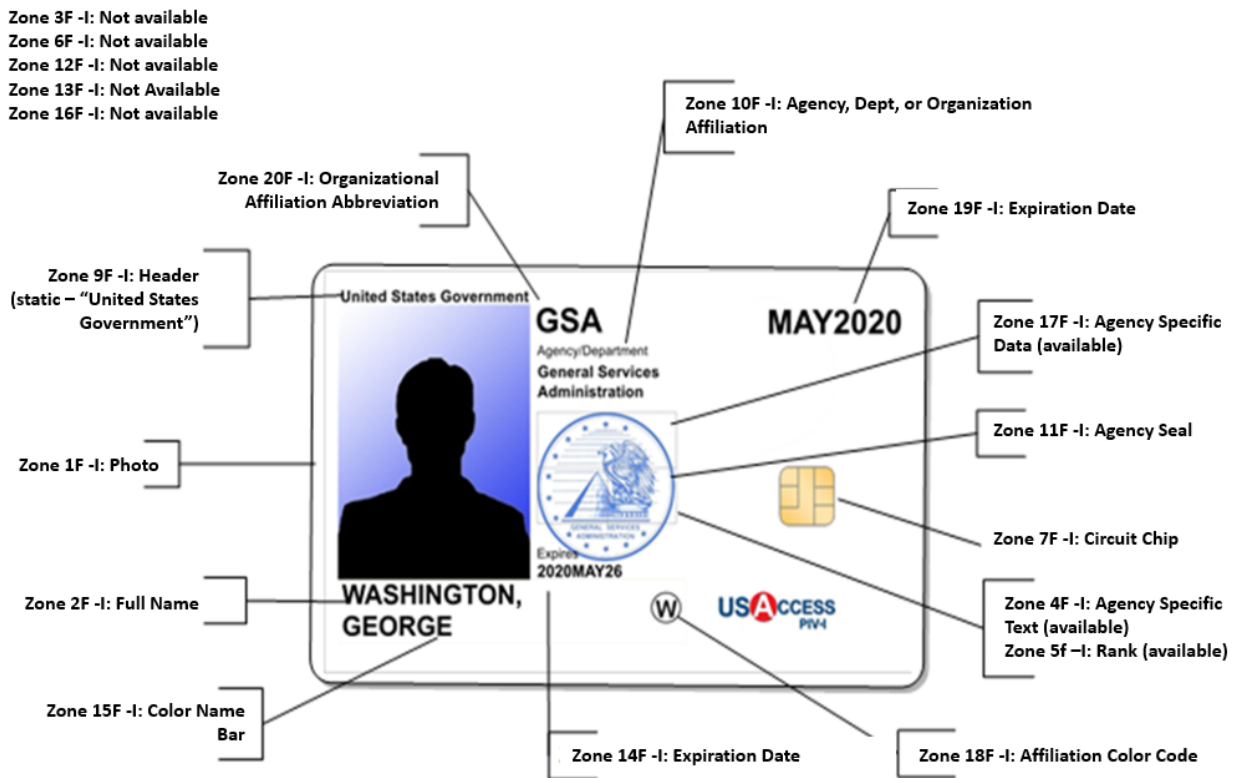
a. Mandatory Items on the Front of the PIV-I Card

(1) Zone 1F-I – Photo

(2) Zone 2F-I – Full Name

- (3) Zone 7F-I – Circuit Chip
 - (4) Zone 9F-I – Header (Static – “United States Government)
 - (5) Zone 10F-I – Agency, Department, or Organization Affiliation
 - (6) Zone 11F-I – Agency Seal
 - (7) Zone 14F-I – Expiration Date
 - (8) Zone 15F-I – Color Name Bar
 - (9) Zone 18F-I – Affiliation Color Code
 - (10) Zone 19F-I – Expiration Date
 - (11) Zone 20F-I – Organizational Affiliation Abbreviation
- b. Optional Items on the Front of the PIV-I Card – Available through the GSA USAccess Program
- (1) Zone 4F-I – Agency Specific Text
 - (2) Zone 5F-I – Rank
 - (3) Zone 17F-I – Agency Specific Data
- c. Optional Items on the Front of the PIV-I Card – Not Available through the GSA USAccess Program
- (1) Zone 3F-I – Signature
 - (2) Zone 6F-I – Portable Data File (PDF) Two-Dimensional Bar Code
 - (3) Zone 12F-I – Footer
 - (4) Zone 13F-I – Issue Date
 - (5) Zone 16F-I – Photo Border

FIGURE 9 - AltLine PIV-I Topology – Card Front



6. BACK REQUIREMENTS OF PIV-I CREDENTIAL

a. Mandatory Items on the Back of the PIV-I Card

- (1) Zone 1B-I – Serial Number
- (2) Zone 2B-I – Issuer Identification Number
- (3) Zone 3B-I – Magnetic Stripe
- (4) Zone 4B-I – Return Address
- (5) Zone 5B-1 – Physical Characteristics
- (6) Zone 7B-I – Section 499, Title 18 Language
- (7) Zone 8B-I – 3 of 9 Bar Code

b. Optional Items on the Back of the PIV-I Card – Not Available through the GSA USAccess Program

(1) Zone 6B-I – Additional Language for Emergency Response Officials

FIGURE 10 - AltLinc PIV-I Topology – Card Back



1 APPENDIX F

2
3 MEMORANDUM FOR MISSION AREAS, AGENCIES AND STAFF OFFICES

4
5 THROUGH: Anita R. Adkins
6 Director, Office of Human Resources Management (OHRM)
7 Donald W. Baker Jr.
8 Director, Office of Contracting and Procurement (OCP) (Acting)
9

10 FROM: Matt Allen
11 Director, Office of Homeland Security (OHS)
12

13 SUBJECT: Hiring Non-United States (U.S.) Citizens as Federal Employees or
14 Federal Contractors
15

16 Effective Date: The Memorandum supersedes memorandum dated April 17, 2023
17

18 Expiration Date: Effective until canceled, superseded or incorporated in Departmental
19 Regulation
20

21 **BACKGROUND:** Executive Order 11935, Citizenship Requirements for Federal
22 Employment (September 2, 1976) restricts appointing non-citizens in competitive service
23 positions covered by Title 5, United States Code (U.S.C.). Since the passage of the
24 Immigration Reform and Control Act of 1986, employers have been responsible for ensuring
25 that the people they hire are eligible to work in the United States (U.S.). The Immigration
26 and Nationality Act of 1990 added other requirements, one of which is that employers may
27 not discriminate against employees by requesting more or different documents than required.
28 The Immigration and Nationality Act, as modified, provides at 8 U.S.C. 1324(a), that it is
29 unlawful for a person or other entity to employ an undocumented noncitizen. In 1996, Public
30 Law (P.L.) 104-208 stated that the term “entity” includes an entry in any branch of the
31 Federal Government. Regulations that implement immigration laws are published in Title 8,
32 Code of Federal Regulations (CFR).
33

34 **PURPOSE:** The purpose of this memorandum is to implement 5 CFR 7.3, §213.3102(bb),
35 and §338.101, in conjunction with the Immigration Reform and Control Act of 1986,
36 Immigration and Nationality Act of 1990, P.L. 104-208, 8 U.S.C. 13249(a), 8, CFR 274(a),
37 the Consolidated Appropriations Act (Fiscal Year 2022, Division E, Section 704) ban on
38 paying certain non-citizen, general statutory restrictions that may be applicable to Mission
39 Areas, Agencies and Staff Offices, and general statutory restrictions on the expenditure of
40 funds.
41

42 This memorandum applies to all competitive service Federal positions and Federal contractor
43 positions within the U.S. Department of Agriculture in the continental United States. This
44 memorandum does not apply to non-U.S. citizens who are:

45 a. A citizen of another country and the U.S. at the same time (dual U.S. citizenship or dual
46 U.S. nationality).

1
2 b. Hired for excepted service or Senior Executive Service Federal appointments in the
3 continental U.S., as permitted by immigration law and any appropriations act ban.
4

5 c. Employed by a Federal contractor on a temporary H-1B (Specialty Occupation) visa in
6 accordance with immigration laws.
7

8 d. Working with USDA through formal educational and professional exchange programs,
9 such as USDA sponsored J-1 visa holders.
10

11 e. Supporting USDA through international agreements for resources, such as wildland
12 firefighters with the Forest Service for not more than 120 days, with another country.
13

14 f. Deferred Action for Childhood Arrivals (DACA) recipients obtaining Federal internships
15 through third-party organizations or fellowship programs.
16

17 g. Locally Employed Staff (LE Staff) providing support in U.S. embassies and consulates
18 worldwide.
19

20 **POLICY:**

21 It is the policy of the Federal Government to employ only U.S. citizens or persons owing
22 permanent allegiance to the U.S. under 5 CFR 213.3102(bb)1a non-citizen may be hired in
23 the absence of a qualified citizen when authorized by the Office of Personnel Management
24 (OPM). §7.3(c) grants OPM the authority, as an exception to this rule and to the extent
25 permitted by law, to authorize the appointment of noncitizens to positions in the competitive
26 service when necessary to promote the efficiency of the service in specific cases or for
27 temporary appointments. Non-citizens may only be employed in positions that do not involve
28 significant authority and responsibility in connection with the management of the
29 Department. The term “management” includes, but is not limited to, planning, programming,
30 policy formulation, direction, supervision of operations, and control.
31

32 A non-citizen hired in the absence of a qualified citizen may only be given a Schedule A
33 excepted appointment (5 CFR 213.3102(bb) and must be approved by OPM. The position
34 must be withdrawn from the competitive service for the period it is filled by the non-citizen.
35 T non-citizen hire will not acquire competitive status and may not be promoted or reassigned
36 to another position in the competitive service, except in situations where a qualified citizen is
37 not available.
38

39 Non-citizens may only be employed through Schedule A if all of the requirements of general
40 statutory restrictions on the expenditure of funds, special statutory restrictions applicable to
41 USDA, Immigration law, and the Appropriations Act ban on pay are met. Additionally, only
42 OPM is authorized to approve exceptions to this rule and appoint noncitizens in the
43 competitive service when the hire is a temporary appointment, or the position ensures the
44 efficiency of the service (Title 5 CFR § 7.3).

1 Unlawful Employment of Aliens -- Criminal Penalties. Title 8 U.S.C. §1324a(a)(1)(A) makes
2 it unlawful for any person or other entity to hire, recruit, or refer for a fee, for employment in
3 the United States an alien knowing the alien is an unauthorized alien.

4 Annual appropriations prohibit the use of funds for the compensation of any Federal
5 government employee or officer in the continental United States unless that person is:

6 a. A U.S. citizen,

7
8 b. A Lawful Permanent Resident (LPR) who is applying for naturalization,

9
10 c. A person admitted as a refugee or granted asylum who has filed a declaration of intent to
11 become an LPR and eventually a U.S. citizen, or

12
13 d. A non-citizen, U.S. national who owes allegiance to the United States (e.g., a person born
14 in American Samoa).

15
16 Mission Areas, Agencies, and Staff Offices shall adhere to the below position designation
17 alignment standards:

18 a. Low Risk (Non-Sensitive) duties may be performed by U.S. Citizens or non-U.S. Citizens.
19 If the individual has not continuously resided in the U.S. or its territories for the last three or
20 more years immediately preceding federal affiliation, they must have an alternative Special
21 Agreement Check (SAC) completed. A Tier 1 must be initiated as soon as they meet the
22 residency requirement.

23
24 b. Moderate Risk (Public Trust) duties may be performed by U.S. Citizens or LPRs with at
25 least three or more years of U.S. residency from the date of legal entry to the U.S. in order to
26 meet investigative requirements.

27
28 c. High Risk (Public Trust) duties may be performed only by U.S. Citizens.

29
30 Non-U.S. citizens must have the appropriate fully adjudicated background investigation
31 before the establishment of a work start date.

32 Current non-U.S. citizens in positions that do not align with this memorandum may be
33 reviewed OHRM on a case-by-case basis while they continue working. If the individual
34 moves positions, they are subject to the above restrictions.

35
36 **CONTRACTOR EMPLOYMENT ELIGIBILITY VERIFICATION.**

37 Federal Acquisition Regulation (FAR) Subpart 22.18 section 22.1802:2

38 2 <https://www.acquisition.gov/far/part-22>

39 a. Statutes and Executive orders require employers to abide by the immigration laws of the
40 United States and to employ in the United States only individuals who are eligible to work in
41 the United States. The E-Verify program provides an Internet-based means of verifying
42 employment eligibility of workers employed in the United States but is not a substitute for
43 any other employment eligibility verification requirements.

44
45 b. Contracting officers shall include in solicitations and contracts, as prescribed at 22.1803,
46 requirements that Federal contractors must-

1
2 c. Enroll as Federal contractors in E-Verify;
3

4 d. Use E-Verify to verify employment eligibility of all new hires working in the United
5 States, except that the contractor may choose to verify only new hires assigned to the contract
6 if the contractor is-

7
8 i. An institution of higher education (as defined at 20 U.S.C. 1001(a));
9

10 ii. A State or local government or the government of a Federally recognized Indian tribe; or
11

12 iii. A surety performing under a takeover agreement entered into with a Federal agency
13 pursuant to a performance bond;

14 e. Use E-Verify to verify employment eligibility of all employees assigned to the contract;
15 and
16

17 f. Include these requirements, as required by the clause at 52.222-54, in subcontracts for-
18

19 (i) Services, except for commercial services that are part of the purchase of a commercially
20 available off-the-shelf (COTS) item (or an item that would be a COTS item, but for minor
21 modifications), performed by the COTS provider, and are normally provided for that COTS
22 item; and construction.

23 Mission Areas, Agencies, and Staff Offices shall adhere to the below position designation
24 alignment standards:

25 a. Low Risk (Non-Sensitive) duties may be performed by U.S. Citizens or non-U.S. Citizens.
26 If the individual has not continuously resided in the U.S. or its territories for the last three or
27 more years immediately preceding federal affiliation, they must have an alternative Special
28 Agreement Check (SAC) completed. A Tier 1 must be initiated as soon as they meet the
29 residency requirement.
30

31 b. Moderate Risk (Public Trust) duties may be performed by U.S. Citizens or LPRs with at
32 least three or more years of U.S. residency from the date of legal entry to the U.S. in order to
33 meet investigative requirements.
34

35 c. High Risk (Public Trust) duties may be performed only by U.S. Citizens.
36

37 Non-U.S. citizens must have the appropriate fully adjudicated background investigation
38 before the establishment of a work start date.

39 Current non-U.S. citizens in positions that do not align with this memorandum may be
40 reviewed OHRM and OCP respectively on a case-by-case basis in while they continue
41 working. If the individual moves positions, they are subject to the above restrictions.
42

43 **APPROVAL PROCESS for EMPLOYEES:** In cases where no qualified U.S. citizens or
44 nationals are available to fill a competitive service position, the respective servicing HR
45 office must submit a request to OHRM for review and submission to OPM for approval to

- 1 remove the position from the competitive service and fill it with an eligible non-citizen,
2 provided immigration law and other legal requirements are met. The request should contain:
3 a. A thorough justification why a U.S. citizen cannot be hired to fill the position, including a
4 detailed description of their efforts to recruit qualified U.S. citizens;
5
6 b. A detailed justification of the qualifications of the non-U.S. citizen;
7
8 c. A copy of the official position description;
9
10 d. A copy of the vacancy announcement; and
11
12 e. The applications from other candidates and a detailed justification explaining why they
13 were not selected.
14

15 In cases where OPM grants approval, the position remains in the excepted service for the
16 duration it is filled by the eligible non-U.S. citizen.
17

18 **WAIVER PROCESS for CONTRACTORS:** The E-Verify program provides an internet-
19 based means of verifying the employment eligibility of workers employed in the United
20 States. Without exception, non-U.S. citizens must be verified through the e-Verify program.
21 Individuals hired to perform work under FAR Clause 52.222-54 and verified through E-
22 verify may perform work in low and moderate risk positions without waiver. A waiver may
23 not be granted for work in high-risk public trust positions.
24

25 **POLICY EXCEPTIONS**

26 Although Federal appropriations laws and regulations significantly limit the availability of
27 Federal employment for Deferred Action for Childhood Arrivals (DACA) recipients, these
28 limitations do not entirely exclude them from performing any work in Federal government
29 offices. DACA recipients may be employed in a Schedule C position. A Schedule C
30 employee is determining nature or because it involves a close and confidential working
31 relationship with the agency head or other top appointed official. Persons with this type of
32 appointment range from secretaries and chauffeurs to policy advisors. Appointments to
33 Schedule C positions require advance approval from the White House Office of Presidential
34 Personnel and OPM. OPM does not review the qualifications of a Schedule C appointee;
35 final authority on this matter rests with the appointing official [5 CFR 213.3301].
36 one occupying a position that is excepted from the competitive service because of its policy-
37 determining nature or because it involves a close and confidential working relationship with
38 the agency head or other top appointed official. Persons with this type of appointment range
39 from secretaries and chauffeurs to policy advisors. Appointments to Schedule C positions
40 require advance approval from the White House Office of Presidential Personnel and OPM.
41 OPM does not review the qualifications of a Schedule C appointee; final authority on this
42 matter rests with the appointing official [5 CFR 213.3301].³

43 The J-1 visa status permits a qualified nonimmigrant alien, i.e., an alien who is not a lawful
44 permanent resident (also known as a “green card holder”), to temporarily reside in the United
45 States to teach, study, observe, conduct research, consult, demonstrate special skills or

1 receive on-the-job training for periods ranging from a few weeks to several years at colleges
2 and universities, hospitals, research institutions, as well as the private sector.
3 The H-1B program applies to employers seeking to hire nonimmigrant aliens as workers in
4 specialty occupations or as fashion models of distinguished merit and ability. A specialty
5 occupation is one that requires the application of a body of highly specialized knowledge and
6 the attainment of at least a bachelor's degree or its equivalent. The intent of the H-1B
7 provisions is to help employers who cannot otherwise obtain needed business skills and
8 abilities from the US workers by authorizing the temporary employment of qualified
9 individuals who are not otherwise authorized to work in the US. USDA Mission Areas,
10 Agencies and Staff Offices are not prohibited awarding contracts to companies that hire
11 immigrants on H-1B visas.
12

13 **INQUIRIES:** Questions regarding this memorandum can be directed to:

14 OHRM: Michael Rafferty, Director, Human Resources Policy Division at:

15 Michael.Rafferty@usda.gov

16 OCP: Chief, Procurement Policy Division (PPD) at: Procurement.Policy@usda.gov

17 OHS: Personnel Security Questions: PerSec@usda.gov//Foreign Visitor Questions:

18 FVALiaison@usda.gov

19 OPI: Office of Human Resources Management and Office of Contracting and Procurement.
20

1 APPENDIX G

2
3 MEMORANDUM FOR AGENCY USDA PERSONNEL SECURITY OFFICES

4
5 FROM: Camellia Murdock
6 Chief, Personnel and Document Security Division (PDSD)

7
8 SUBJECT: INVESTIGATION REQUIREMENTS FOR FOREIGN
9 NATIONALS NOT MEETING U.S. RESIDENCY
10 REQUIREMENTS FOR A TIER 1

11
12 BACKGROUND

13 On December 15, 2020, the Office of Personnel Management (OPM), in its capacity
14 as the Credentialing Executive Agent and Suitability Executive Agent, issued a
15 memorandum titled, Credentialing Standards Procedures for Issuing Personnel
16 Identity Verification Cards under HSPD-12 and New Requirements for Suspension
17 or Revocation of Eligibility for Personal Identity Verification Credentials
18 (Credentialing Standards).

19
20 The memorandum guidance covers all individuals including any person who
21 performs, or who seeks to perform, work for or on behalf of the executive branch,
22 such as Federal employees and contractors, or those who interact with the executive
23 branch, such as guest researchers, volunteers, and seasonal employees, in a way that
24 requires vetting.

25
26 The intent of the memorandum was to provide greater detail and clarity on several
27 areas, to include existing policy on the investigation requirements and credentialing
28 process for non-United States nationals (foreign nationals). Due to limitations in an
29 Investigative Service Provider's (ISP) ability to collect background investigation
30 information in locations outside the United States, alternative investigative action is
31 needed for a foreign national.

32
33 INVESTIGATION REQUIREMENTS

34 Prior to releasing a background investigation on a foreign national, Personnel
35 Security offices must review the "Where You Have Lived" section on the Standard
36 Form 85, Questionnaire for Non-Sensitive Positions.

37 ☐ A Tier 1 investigation can be requested on a foreign national who has been
38 in the United States or a United States Territory for 3 or more years,
39 continuously and immediately preceding the start of Federal affiliation.

40 ☐ A Tier 1 investigation cannot be requested on a foreign national who has
41 been in the United States or a United States Territory for less than 3 years
42 preceding the start of Federal affiliation.

43
44 For foreign nationals who do not meet the above residency requirement for a Tier 1,
45 Personnel Security offices must alternatively request a Special Agreement Check
46 (SAC – OFI 86C, updated June 2022), case type 92, with our ISP, the Defense

Counterintelligence and Security Agency (DCSA), coded accordingly to obtain the following four checks:

- a. FBI fingerprint based National Criminal History Check (NCHC) – **code B0** (numerical zero); must obtain a classifiable result. Resubmit new fingerprint chart if initial result is returned as unclassifiable.
- b. FBI Investigations Files (FBIF; Name Check) – **code C0** (numerical zero)
- c. Name check against the Terrorist Screening Database (TSDB) – satisfied through the above classifiable FBI fingerprint check which includes a check of the Known and Suspected Terrorist File.
- d. US Citizenship and Immigration Services (USCIS) check against the Systematic Alien Verification for Entitlements (SAVE) program – **code I0** (numerical zero)

This alternative SAC option provided by DCSA is supported by PDSD and is effective immediately. PDSD will include this language in future Departmental Regulation (DR) updates.

The requesting agency is required to maintain the signed release for the individual from the SF85 to support the SAC. Personnel Security offices will document these checks as SACs (Inv Type field) on the Entry on Duty screen in the web-based Security Entry Tracking System (webSETS).

Foreign nationals who have a favorably adjudicated SAC will be issued an alternative identity credential until the individual has resided for 3 years in the United States or United States Territory, at which time a Tier 1 investigation can be requested.

In addition to the SAC submission, and to further support the overall risk determination on a foreign national, agencies are reminded to submit foreign national vetting (FNV) checks to the Office of Homeland Security (OHS) in accordance with DR 4600-004, *Foreign National Visits and Assignments Vetting*, which requires additional screening on a foreign national prior to their arrival or onboarding of a foreign national at a USDA facility, or working remotely, in the United States.

QUESTIONS

For questions concerning Personnel Security requirements, please contact Dianica Knox at Dianica.knox@usda.gov.

For questions concerning the FNV program, please contact Carrie Moore at carrie.moore@usda.gov.